

A SENSE OF COMPLETION



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THE FULL 'SECTION ONE' FROM THE
ORIGINAL DRAFT OF
ORGANIC PSYCHOLOGY

A SENSE OF COMPLETION

(1.0)

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PREFACE

As indicated in Organic Psychology, this section was almost entirely edited out of that work because, whilst it is important, it is also a rather large subject in and of itself, as you can see.

Being a summary definition of the positive functioning that has been eroded away, it heads in completely the opposite direction to the rest of 2EQ in one sense – focusing not so much on the damage we suffer, or on what causes that, but on where we might return once all of that is taken care of. In defining an outline of this lost positivity, it also sets this in stark contrast to what we generally see, and thereby goes some ways toward explaining just how widespread and obvious the damage 2EQ addresses really is. It is all around us, right in front of us all the time, but we just can't see it because everyone has it.

In this context, and as it was originally intended, this book still remains a good introductory primer to my first attempt at capturing what has now become known as 2EQ – Organic Psychology.

It is provided here as it was originally put down, even though – as one of the first things I ever wrote – it remains embarrassingly undigested and rudimentary in many respects.

A SENSE OF COMPLETION

OUR SEARCH for greater happiness and fulfilment in life is the central focus of this work, and whilst there is an entirely new view I will be seeking to outline, it is, nevertheless, worth first of all examining some of the things we already presume. This will be our task in this section. In some ways this entire section can be seen as an extended introduction to the issues we will be dealing with in the remaining sections. It will be a view of life from the surface of things, and - rather than anything radically new - it will be a closer look at some of the things we already tend to believe. Still very valuable however, because what we already presume itself has some implications most people are unaware of.

As we look at common culture, and all the things we do in pursuit of greater happiness, we can see

certain overall patterns or issues often confronted. These issues are nothing secret or new, but in this section I will seek to offer my own summary and overview to see if I can illustrate more clearly what we are seeking to achieve in these pursuits, and how they all relate to each other.

In particular, this will be a quick gloss over the two main approaches offered by our current culture as modes of deep personal change, *inner* and *outer* respectively. And contrary to what you may suspect, my conviction here is that these approaches are not essentially wrong, but that when restored to their natural potential they do in fact represent authentic positive functioning, desirable elements of our full potential which have been eroded over time by the presence of the underlying conflict, but that - as a result of this erosion - they do remain deeply misunderstood, and definitely somewhat afflicted.

So what you are already doing is probably quite correct, it is just not quite working properly. And as we do this we'll naturally be picking up on these obvious afflictions as we go. My hope is that it will become clear that the obstacles we will confront here, as we examine these approaches, are evidence of the underlying antagonist which is the subject of the remainder of this work.

Also, due to the problems they suffer, these common approaches are the focus of considerable cultural debate as to their ultimate virtues, so we'll also be bringing some of these underlying cultural debates to light.

Although we will be taking only the surface view here, examining the logical implications of things we already believe, this should not be seen as insignificant in any way. For although I already indicated that the underlying conflict is difficult to point out in surface terms, I'll seek to demonstrate

here that it can still be seen quite clearly if you know where to look. That, in fact, we confront it all the time, but simply don't recognise it as such.

The primary benefits of ironing the wrinkles out of these common approaches are twofold -

- Firstly, we will confront obstacles, and in doing so begin to see what we are up against.
- Secondly, we will gain a more refined view of the essential positivity which has been lost - the ideal to which we all seek to return.

So in order to see where these approaches are getting snagged, we will need to iron the wrinkles out of them and examine them in ideal terms. Which means we should gradually get a clearer picture of what this conflict has taken from us. And this should not be overlooked, or undervalued, for this is in fact where we will eventually return again at the end - once we know what it means to earn freedom from the primary dilemma - to reclaim what was lost. Who knows, we may even gain some immediately useful insight. At the very least, we will be introducing many of the underlying questions and issues the remainder of this work will seek to answer or address. To begin with then: a look at what we often find when we look *within* ourselves for answers.

1st Half : Inward

BEING YOURSELF

A happy life is one in accord with its own nature.
- Seneca

What is before us, and what is beyond us, is nothing compared to what is within us.

- Henry David Thoreau

PERHAPS the most obvious source of persistent unease in life for many people is the relationship they have to their own deeper nature, their own inner self and subjective realities. The crucial distinction to be recognised here is the difference between what arises deep in our being (feelings, drives, impulses, attractions, repulsions, intuitions....), and what is expressed or embodied in our 'frontal personality', our outward social expression. For the moment, these deeper elements of ourselves I will call our 'core', and the issue we will be discussing is the degree of alignment or integrity that exists between these two important aspects of ourselves; i.e. how well the social 'mask' you wear actually fits you the 'wearer'. In other words, the question is this: Are you being true to who you really are, and living in tune with that? Or are you living a lie?

In historical terms the frontal personality or 'social mask' has been dubbed the persona, and the relationship we are discussing here is a basic tenet of much common psychology. Therefore, I won't dwell here long, as there are a million and one books on this basic stuff, all of which will do it more justice than I. But I will at least take the time to offer a simplified summary in my own terms just to give us a head start, as this does tend to be a bit misunderstood, and confused with other things.

The basic premise here seems to be that the persona is an interface between your deeper self and the world of relations and interactions. It is a go-between, a bridge which spans the two worlds - inner and outer - and should, ideally, be well adapted to both. Our persona is often heavily conditioned by the external environment, by our parents and schooling etc. But the crucial point to realise is that it is primarily a product of the core, and is supposed to represent that deeper self's interests in the world of relational exchange. It has a function, a reason for existing, the implications of which are that within our own system as a whole it is designed to be a servant, not a master. And this is apparently where the trouble often seems to begin. Because all too often we are told who we must be, and how we must act, without consideration for any deeper consequences. And the result is that we sometimes lose touch with aspects of who we really are beneath our rigidly imposed exterior. This creates trouble for the simple reason that it is a violation of the way we are supposed to work, and because there are functions in place within us to ensure the integrity of this core-surface relationship. Functions which, if misalignment occurs, are designed to generate tension like the stretching of a rubber band. We simply don't feel good if we are not acting in accord with who we really are, and what we really feel. And this is an abiding source of dis-ease for a great many people, because the kind of misalignment we are

discussing here is very common indeed. In fact, this is all of us to some degree.

When we seek to examine the origins of this rift in ourselves, we are often led to the fact that the essential process we are discussing - that of finding an appropriate self expression - has not been fostered or effectively modelled in our culture. That this inner connection to our own deeper selves is established and maintained via a series of processes which must be refined over time, and which must at least in part be learned from others. We must, in growing up, have these processes modelled for us in order to adapt to them in ourselves. And here we see the first hint of something we will be returning to again and again throughout the duration of this work - that being: the relationship between the individual and culture. I'm talking about mainstream culture here, and in this instance addressing the possibility that in common culture we often find a lack of such healthy modelling. That, therefore, culture often does not support this vital element of integrity in the individual.

I believe this absence tends to reflect an even deeper and more serious cultural issue - a generally fearful orientation toward our deeper selves as a whole. We are not generally encouraged to look within ourselves for guidance, but rather to seek the advice of some 'authority'. All of which embodies a mistrust of ourselves which has, for generations, been institutionalised in many of our social structures.

Much or even most of the origins of the gap between surface and core we often struggle with seem to be in our early development, and its degree of seriousness, likewise, seems to have a lot to do with the kind of environment you experienced as a child. 'Significant others' had great power over us as children, and we did not have the same

psychological and emotional defence systems we now take for granted as adults. We were extremely vulnerable. And when our world did not accept a particular element of our character, we ourselves will have learned to deny and ignore that part out of necessity.

All of which means that in seeking to restore a sense of inner flow and natural self expression, many people find themselves going back to examine their own upbringing. And it becomes more important and relevant to understand not only the nature, but also the origins, of this inner rift.

Looking back, then, we can see that because the establishment of this connection between core and persona requires healthy modelling in order to emerge, and because this modelling is especially important in an individual's early development, that its historical neglect could also reflect the simple realities of our historical circumstances, the basic hardships of war and poverty. As a parent or caregiver under any circumstances, it is simply more demanding to model - for a child - the process by which to accurately define and express who they truly are, than it is to simply tell them who they are, or who you may need them to be. This is difficult enough in the best of circumstances some would say, so we can presume that it is especially the case in difficult times, and most especially if such was never afforded you - the caregiver - when you yourself were a child. You simply cannot give what you haven't got, what you yourself weren't given, and cannot teach what you never learned to do yourself. Unfortunate but true. Like so many things, this is a healthy pattern of functioning which we must learn from seeing it in action, and gradually adapt to by emulation. Which means that if this necessary transmission between generations is broken, then subsequent generations can often struggle to recover it. All of which leads

to a vicious cycle, the proverbial blind leading the blind.

On the subject of transmission, however, it is not only the lack of healthy modelling we often suffer from - not only a passive absence - but also the possibility of distinct negative patterns being transmitted between generations. Not merely the absence of good patterns from which we might learn, but the presence or even forced imposition of dysfunctional patterns. Many of which are even considered virtuous and desirable, and even imposed in the name of 'love'. So how can you tell the difference?

It is of course mandatory and healthy to receive a kind of 'identity template' from your parents or caregivers as you develop, a 'training wheels persona' you might say. A primary worldview containing core values, beliefs and identity structures etc. This is entirely healthy and appropriate. But this is often not understood by those charged with providing such, that this is the tentative beginnings of an ongoing process of development which will inevitably deconstruct all that in the healthy transition into adulthood. It must. Contrary to this, it seems evident that many parents and teachers do not recognise any distinction at all between persona and core, blindly confusing the surface level with the underlying deeper self. The practical result of which is that instead of seeking out and nurturing the emergence of an individual's unique character, they often seek to 'mould' an individual's persona and impose on it a particular shape or form they see as being desirable, seemingly with little or no respect for the reality of any pre-existing deeper elements.

It is very likely, it seems, that the blindness of caregivers in this respect results simply from having been the victim of the same treatment themselves. For the child, then, growing up under

such care, many deeper or more subtle and vulnerable aspects of self are often lost from subjective awareness as they are directed away from themselves, and eventually can't find their way back.

The unfortunate result of all this, especially if it is severe, is the formation of an imposed or rigid personality structure, one with little or no obvious relationship to the deeper realities of the person, and little capacity for spontaneous expression. A maladapted persona, incapable of responsive or adaptive change on the basis of any changes at that deeper level of self. A child built for war, and incapable of peace. This is when the 'mask weareth the man', and here we see the essential picture of what I am seeking to capture at this level. What we are dealing with here is the loss of authentic self in the very simplest sense. We all suffer from this to some degree, and to whatever degree it remains it is a serious breach of our own system's native integrity, a corruption of a very basic nature. For it is often not the false mask that hurts, as much as the parts of your face you have to cut off in order to make it fit, the aspects of yourself you must avoid acting on, feeling or even becoming aware of. All creating dis-ease.

Your persona is like the cover of a book, and your true character is like the story contained within. And when the cover bears no relationship to that story, then pages can often end up being ripped out and thrown away in an effort to make it all fit. And this is what hurts. And here, also, we see our first glimpse of how culture can affect such corruption. How oppression can create repression, and how simple neglect is itself a powerful form of oppression.

How damaging is this, then? What are the consequences of this rift between surface and core in relation to our own pursuit of happiness?

The cost of the split we are discussing here is not only the felt loss of our authentic self, but also a continual and chronic struggle within. Energetic impulses and influences from the core are supposed to be expressed at a surface level. If not integrated and expressed, they wreak havoc and need to be contained in some forceful way. This is the cause of the overt stress associated with this particular breach of integrity. To uphold a false and rigid persona, we must to some degree effectively deny the existence of our deeper selves, we must actively repress it and keep it from frontal awareness. However, contrary to the common misconception, the needs, impulses and emotive energies of the deeper self do not just disappear or go away if you deny them. The result is simply a division of emotional power, and a limitation on awareness and feeling. Like a repressed and otherwise friendly people, if denied and ignored they turn bitter and scheme covert fulfilment, or even outright revolution.

Most of the activity going on within us is unconscious, with only a tiny amount becoming available to conscious awareness. Which is good, and how it should be. This unconscious army of functioning is there to support the frontal self in doing its job. Unconscious is, by and large, an ally of the conscious self. However, the kind of denial and misalignment we have been discussing here implies a loaded and active unconscious agenda, including forces which act in direct defiance of the then dis-empowered conscious persona. In other words, it creates war. In this state, denied elements of authentic self often develop aberrant forms of fulfilment that undermine the active persona, producing compulsive actions and impulses the frontal personality doesn't consciously initiate, and which it doesn't understand. But which it ends up taking responsibility for regardless. Quite mysterious and very often embarrassing. Just like a repressive regime in a country, such denial often

requires savage and brutal measures in order to maintain control, and here we see another source of tension. This is an unnatural state of affairs, an imbalance, and will always be relatively unstable if not perpetually enforced in some way. It all takes subtle but significant effort. What we are talking about is common neurosis. Like a war being waged, in this state we are continually under attack - not from outside us, but from within ourselves.

Culture

Before we leave this and move on to examine what might be done about this particular rift, it is worth examining the bigger picture for a moment. Something we have already touched on - the whole idea that true character or virtue can be imposed somehow has been a dominating force throughout human history. This is something we are only now beginning to wake up from. And the important factor here is another phenomenon we have already touched on, but which needs to be brought more clearly into the open- That those displaying the most damaging forms of this rift in themselves are often the most ardent and active perpetrators of such on others. The reason for this is perhaps because so much is often suffered or sacrificed on the basis of whatever beliefs or injunctions caused the harm. It seems that, beyond a certain point of oppression, it becomes emotionally difficult for the victim to accept that the offending ethos could be wrong, simply because to accept such would validate and release too much anger at those who originally perpetrated it. The possibility becomes too emotionally uncomfortable. Thus, strangely, the very things which hurt us the most can become our most strongly held convictions, upheld by a wall of pain. And it is in this way, as with many other forms of oppression, that the most deeply abused themselves often become the most strident abusers.

All this is important to realise for one very good reason. Because it indicates the potential for entire cultures to adopt and display a dysfunctional ethos, especially this dark and maladaptive orientation toward deeper self, and display the obvious hallmark characteristics such produces. Bent people create bent social microcosms in which they then appear to be straight, provided nobody seeks to introduce straight functioning. Meaning that, in isolated environments, trauma can spawn trauma in an endless cycle of social dysfunction, tacitly supported and condoned by conventions and institutions which uphold such ideas. As already indicated, simple hardship can produce such imbalances and drive them deep into the psyche of an individual, or a culture. And, which is the point, not only temporarily, but for generations to come. The deeper the negative impact, the more likely it is to be transmitted.

As I already said, our culture itself would seem to be gradually recovering from such a state. Perhaps all cultures have begun there. Fortunately, however, we are now beginning to realise the virtues inherent in the deeper levels of individual people, and are no longer seeking brittle uniformity of mind or character. It is becoming more often recognised that everyone has some form of inherent genius or particular leaning, and that the differences these capacities signify are no longer to be treated as threats, but as assets. There is a sense now emerging of looking beneath the surface of people to appreciate the elements which make them unique as individuals. Things which have often not been chosen or created, so much as they have been discovered in them. Inherent qualities and unique potentials. Which means, in the terms we have been discussing, that it is now becoming normal to consider the worldview and identities we are given as a child as being something like a makeshift coat we are given to

wear until we are capable of fashioning our own in better keeping with our particular shape and size and future requirements. That they are things we should naturally grow out of and replace. In a healthy environment it is expected, and even encouraged, that you will begin to question everything you were told at some stage, and begin to deconstruct it in favour of something better. This is normal development. But as we know, this is often obstructed or doesn't happen, and we are then left to clean up the resulting unhappy state.

On the 'inner' front then, because this rift is so common, and such a great source of pervasive underlying tension, this is where many people begin in their journey back to themselves and toward greater happiness. With a cease-fire in this subtle war, and a gradual reconciliation. We have all 'swallowed things whole' in the process of growing up, not only identities and patterns of behaviour but entire worldviews, and must all embark on the process of vomiting up whatever we were told about the world and who we are, and then to seek to define the truth for ourselves. This is part of what it means to become an adult. To find our own true path, to define who we are, and what we ourselves want or believe or value in life, as opposed to what others may have wished us to want, or to be. And the whole process I am discussing here can sometimes be difficult to figure out, especially at first. You only have to look at a typical teenager to see that. For, as turbulent as it may appear, this is the function of a healthy adolescence: to begin this process, which then continues for life. But there are many things, both subtle and gross, which can represent obstacles to this happening. Effectively, in some sense, preventing adulthood. So this is where we start, this is still where a lot of people get stuck. In having been so forcefully told who they are, instead of being asked, many have severed much contact with their own inner nature, creating a dangerous lack

of intra-personal communication. The forcefully imposed mask, having created this breach, becomes an end unto itself, a tyrant in systemic terms. No longer the servant to the deeper self, it often bears no relationship to it at all. Which means that who we think we are does not reflect the realities of our deeper self or being. All of which means that the process of resolving this rift will very likely involve making friends with parts of ourselves which we have - in merely growing up - become convinced are bad or unacceptable. Which can be very demanding indeed, especially if you remain emotionally dependent on the approval of others.

Emotional dependence

In terms of the process or path this view indicates, and what it demands, one thing stands out as paramount. One of the primary obstacles confronted by anyone seeking to address the rift we are discussing is primary self esteem, and where it is sourced. If we remain heavily dependent on the approval of others, especially primary caregivers [parents], truly questioning the values and identities they have instilled in us could be very difficult indeed. You simply can't remain attached to being a 'good boy-girl', and question the implied values which define such, at the same time. It's like cutting off the emotional branch you're standing on. The same applies to peer groups, and 'being cool'. In many ways emotional dependence is both the cause and the perpetuator of the personal struggle we are addressing.

It is natural for a child to seek approval and validation from significant others. As a dependent, to feel good about yourself demanded that you be whatever these significant others deemed appropriate. Your self esteem came through them. But as an adult such dependence has no place, and

it is often this very factor which makes it difficult to question what others have projected onto us. Residual emotional dependence can make it very difficult to clearly differentiate what you desire for yourself, from what others expect of you. Which means that the whole process of beginning to question and establish our own foundations will first of all demand that we become more self-sufficient in maintaining our own core self esteem, which is itself another whole topic.

What we are discussing, then, are some of the things which help to lay the stable foundations to allow for recovery to take place, and healing to occur. In practical terms - as this relates to self esteem in particular - this means that instead of seeking the approval of some authority figure, we begin to develop our own standards and values on an independent footing. It means that we must learn to take responsibility for defining our own essential worth regardless of what others may choose to think of us. It means to move beyond peer fear as a defining factor in our lives. And far beyond mere identity structures, this overall transition demands the development of an independent worldview. All of which can often demand the courage to stand alone, to be 'different' if need be, and to not allow others to impose their values on us purely on the basis of their supposed 'authority'. In the end we must, if we are going to establish and maintain inner integrity, become 'the' authority concerning our own character. And to do that we must become less emotionally dependent, which demands more than just a few positive affirmations. True autonomous self esteem is founded on the assumption of some very real and serious degrees of personal responsibility.¹

¹ Further reading on self esteem, see Nathaniel Branden. Esp; "The Art of Living Consciously".

We begin to see now some of what may prevent this rift from naturally resolving. Emotional dependence, and the unstable self esteem it fosters, are just two examples of many different negative potentials which have the power to prevent the emergence of the simple integrity we are seeking - an autonomous and appropriate self expression. Both indications of the kinds of thing which could easily be encountered and have to be addressed as we seek to re-establish such integrity and flow, if it has been lost. 'Being yourself' may seem simple at first glance, but the stable emergence of a healthy persona is contingent on many contributing factors, self esteem being only one. It is clear that there are also many other reasons why people might find the prospect of this kind of change scary, but it is obviously not practical for me to attempt an outline of everything which could be encountered along the path we are considering, or what overcoming each may ultimately demand of us. However, one other is worth mentioning - Which is that the 'inner self' we are trying to connect with and give expression to is simply revolting! I mean, quite literally in many cases. If there is a history of neglect or denial of some aspect of your own deeper nature, then there will inevitably be some mistrust or disarray. And to 'feel into' and truly integrate a 'disassociated' aspect of yourself will ultimately demand some degree of surrender to it, and this is not a very appealing prospect for many. Especially when any initial attempts are inevitably met with some degree of systemic scepticism or even inner hostility. And so, as we will find again and again, those least accustomed to feeling, and turning their attention within themselves, often end up confronting the most negative and uncomfortable emotional states. This is the same in many realms I suppose: the most historically inept have the most residual conflict to confront and resolve. The more neglectful, and the longer the duration of it, the more mess there is to clean up. Which is an

unfortunate situation which often leads those who most need such self imposed 'therapy' to perceive such as intolerably scary, confirming their prior beliefs that it's all 'bullshit anyway', allowing them to return safely to their lives of quiet denial and self-abnegation. And why not, each their own. But really, as I already mentioned, that would be OK if only they would keep it all to themselves. The fact is, however, the worse this is, the more likely it is to be imposed on others.

In summary then –

1. There exists an elementary relationship between our surface expression and our inner core.
2. The core, our authentic self, represents pre-existing deeper elements in our character which are always unique in nature.
3. To be happy we must strive to honour these elements and live in alignment with them.
4. Many factors can affect or disrupt this relationship by imposing demands or restrictions, often being institutionalised in cultural conventions and injunctions. In order to recover any degree of lost integrity in this primary relationship, a twofold process of self acceptance and self responsibility must be embarked upon.
5. The result of this is a restoration of primary inner integrity. That being a radiant and unrestricted flow of energy from core to surface, producing an authentic and adaptive outward self expression.

For anyone committed to themselves and deeper fulfilment in life, or perhaps just less swayed by fear, this process becomes naturally established and continues to produce healthy change over time. We learn to open up our deepest fears and

worst parts to others, and in the process they are often transformed as they enter the light. We are many faceted beings, and a softer, more ductile and inclusive persona will generally emerge as various elements of our deeper nature are re-integrated and embodied in life. A truer persona, a more accurate reflection of who we truly are beneath our social mask will emerge, a coat of many layers and colours to reflect our native inner diversity. We become a river catching many currents. In the end, a sense of trust concerning deeper aspects of ourselves re-emerges on the basis of felt co-operation and simple experience. It becomes safer to feel again, a sense of flow returns. The natural human state comes to more closely resemble a wellspring which flows naturally from the core out into the world, without undue restriction: The native human state.

It must also be recognised that what I'm indicating here is not just some temporary therapeutic process, but that it is the beginnings of a permanent and continually ongoing process, the relative success in which is no mean feat. Especially if it has been seriously disturbed in the past. However, success in this does - I believe - have a very significant influence on our capacity to be openly happy in life.

So here is my first main assertion- To be happy in life, you must first have the courage to **be** who you **are**, and stop **making it up**.

This above all, to thine own self be true.

-Shakespeare

Here, then, we have an outline of what, to many, will seem like a daunting level of personal change- The process of establishing and maintaining a creative interface between our deeper selves and

the changing world. One which is both adaptive to the environment at the same time as being an authentic expression of who we truly are. A dynamic and responsive bridge between these two continually moving worlds. A creative solution. And all of which obviously implying the relinquishment or de-construction of anything out-dated or inappropriate, no matter what its origins. And that's the bit that scares most. And whilst it may all sound pretty profound, many healthy adults do this automatically, at least in essence. In fact what we are discussing here is just normal healthy functioning, which has been somewhat disturbed by external factors to create this breach of integrity. Meaning that as healthy family culture is gradually restored, and people freed from such oppression, these positive patterns will return of their own accord over time. Also, fortunately, some were not so victim to the force of other's agendas in their upbringing, and, even if it's a bit bumpy, thus make this transition naturally and quite securely in adolescence. So I hope all this doesn't scare you too much, because it is actually the most shallow level of personal change we will be addressing in this work. The absolute primers. As I said, where most people begin.²

So let's move on. There are, as we'll now see, some other very good reasons why healing this rift can be more difficult than we might otherwise presume.

The reality of Change

² So many paths and methods to choose from here. If you were interested to look more deeply at this elementary level, I'd suggest an easy introduction to Transactional Analysis or Script Analysis as a starting point.

SA- 'What do you say after you say hello?' -Eric Bern.

TA- 'I'm Ok, You're Ok'. -T Harris

A focus of much debate in common culture is the presence and reality of change in human life. Something which seems to be brought to light by what we've just covered. Central to this debate is the question of what we can, and what we cannot, change in life, and in ourselves. And change itself is an issue which will come up again in the progression of this work. At this level, however, it seems pretty clear that people can indeed change, at least in relation to their own inner nature. That they can at least change on a surface level. And that, therefore, the relationship between a person's core and their surface expression can also change, and that it does so often. It is natural to assume then, that such change can be deliberately instigated and actualised to great positive effect.

However, many people remain deeply afraid of change, especially inner change. Which is perhaps understandable in certain circumstances, but what is most disturbing is that this can sometimes happen even to the point of denying the existence of personal change altogether. In fact, I once heard it said- "you are what you are when you're born!". Meaning that people really don't change, ever. That they are static 'things', fixed at birth. So I thought I had better at least introduce this issue here. For, as we will come to see in more depth, change is a basic fact. The basic fact perhaps. That, actually, in reality, there is nothing but change. Time, itself, is change. And that, in a very real sense, change is one of the only true constants in the universe as we know it, of which we are an intrinsic part. Although patterns sometimes persist for a time, the only thing that truly never changes is the fact that everything is always changing. Which seems to suggest, to my mind, that the most obvious wisdom in life must be to flow with this river of change, rather than push against it continually. It seems clear, however, that this fact is very resisted by many. And that these people suffer greatly as a result.

To step back for a moment, we can see that the assertion or belief that people do not change is an intrinsic part of the ethos we addressed above which produces and perpetuates the elementary rift between core and surface expression. It is part of the idea that we can be fixed or rigid. An ethos which I believe can be clearly characterised as a kind of obvious pathology. To believe that we are static and fixed things is, to my mind, about as lost as you can get. It seems to be so far removed from the obvious facts of existence as to prompt the question of how such an idea could come about, and what might support it? But such a view is more common than you might otherwise presume, and has many negative social consequences.³ The most obvious foundation of such an assertion, however, is fear. Fear of ourselves in fact. So why is there so much fear? Surely this fear would seem somewhat out of proportion to the gravity of the risks involved? At least as we've so far defined them. Yes, but there is something else. Perhaps, I believe, the real reason people are so deeply afraid.

Deep Emotive Processes

One thing we haven't really picked up on yet is that whilst the persona may remain stable in relation to the core, the healthy core is always in its own gradual process of natural change and adaptation. I will explain in a moment why this is, but what this means in relation to what we have been looking at thus far is that any healthy and truly adaptive persona must, at least to some degree, be a fluid one. It can never be fixed, but must always be part

³ This assertion, when institutionalized in any way, offers no recourse socially. There is no room for constructive *criticism* if you believe people can't ever change. All such a view has to offer is *condemnation*. It is a very destructive thought indeed, often held and wielded by those most damaged by it themselves. It is, I believe, simply a deeply inhuman thing to believe.

of a continual process of re-invention and re-generation. And this is clearly a major complicating factor in what we have been addressing. It means that to really connect with our own deeper self, in the sense I have been advocating, is to submit to a process of continual change.

What is this 'core change' then, and what does it mean in our lives? In order to explain this I will need to briefly explain what the core does. The core, as I am using the term, represents the central element of a very complex hierarchy within us responsible for ensuring our many transactional needs remain met in a complex and changing world. The persona is another element of the hierarchy - the periphery - and between the core and the surface persona is emotion.

Emotion is designed to influence surface behaviour and thus direct the frontal self toward necessary actions. Emotion is a systemic tension, you could say, designed to apply leverage and achieve certain ends for the organism as a whole. Emotion, in its many different forms, is both the whip and the carrot, the force with which the core drives and directs conscious action in life.

The core itself, however, is not emotion. The core is the underlying body of functioning which produces emotion by dynamically allocating and shifting the primary foundations of emotion- attachment. The heart of core emotive functioning is attachment. In essential overall terms, it is attachment which represents relational need. Attachment signifies the amount of precious energy the system will sacrifice to protect its connection to a particular source of fulfilment. All emotion ultimately relates back to attachment at some level. And attachment, correctly allocated, should always accurately represent need. Managing all this is the job of the core.

In order to achieve its purpose, then, the core requires functions which build, maintain, and alter our inner 'architecture' so as to remain relevant and appropriate in a changing environment. These functions, once again, are not emotions per se, but will often produce powerful emotive expressions in their operation. I will call these functions- deep emotive processes. When change is required at a deep level within us, these are the processes which make it happen. When the system is bent out of shape, it is a deep emotive process which bends it back. When something is lost, it is a deep emotive process which restores it. When adaptation to outer change is required, it is a deep emotive process which affects that change. Not the buildings of our inner world, these processes are the builders. They construct, and deconstruct, and alter our emotional landscapes.

These same deep emotive processes also fulfil other vital roles, including our capacity to absorb emotional impacts. They are the functions which heal emotional wounds and restore damaged equilibrium. So, amongst other things, they protect our core and its integrity. They are our core's own defences, you could say. At the surface behavioural level, frustration, grief and fear are all examples of deep emotive processes in action beneath. And just like any other systemic process, these functions have a beginning, a middle, and an end. They have a function to fulfil, and when that's done, they're gone. They arise on the basis of a demand, they fulfil that demand, and then disappear again. And when there's no demand, they simply don't arise. Stillness.

The principal distinction between emotion and deep emotive process is that the function of emotion is to produce change in the outer world of behaviour, whereas the function of a deep emotive process is to produce change in the inner world

from which emotions arise. Deep emotive processes simply maintain the machinery, they are the functions which protect and uphold the natural integrity of the system, and are themselves a reflection of that primary integrity. In a very real sense, it could be said that these functions are the core, and that it is through them that the fluid and dynamic core acts to keep us 'in tune' with our changing environment.

So how does this relate to what we have been discussing? Well, we can now see some of the challenges facing the establishment of a more responsive and accurate self expression - that in doing so, we must in some ways submit to a process of continual adaptation to reflect the changes at the core, changes affected by specific functions whose very purpose for existence is to do exactly that - change us. Perhaps this is all that scares us, the prospect of deep personal change?

I believe the real issue, however, is not only fear of gradual change. But lies in the fact that these primary emotive processes can, seemingly, be suspended. That the core can be shut down to some degree, and that the rift between surface and core we have been discussing is one of the things which can produce this suspension. You see, deep emotive processes require certain key factors in order to fulfil their function within the system, and they can literally be suspended mid-flight by removing some of these prerequisites. Specifically, to achieve their purpose, deep emotive processes operate in a kind of spiralling communication between many levels of self, they are an integrating force, and cannot function when the 'lines are down' so to speak, when communication has been severed or is blocked.

Which, when you think about it, has direct implications concerning the rupture we have been addressing above between surface and core. Could that rift not have some of its origins in the need to control deep emotive processes? Yes, this seems very reasonable. In fact, this is the general presumption of much psychology at present: that the need to resist or suspend such deep emotive processes is the primary origin of the common rift between core and surface many people struggle with. That it generally occurs as a direct result of trauma or stress, and the desire to avoid the powerful deep emotive processes such produce. In this sense, the rupture between surface and core can be seen merely as a kind of 'circuit breaker', and therefore just a symptom of something even deeper. A symptom of deep process suspension. In fact, contrary to what I already asserted about the origins of the core-surface rift, it is even possible that external events do not directly create that rift at all, because if deep emotive processes cause it, then anything which stimulates powerful deep emotive processes may force the system to do this to itself. And deep emotive processes are not always the result of external stimulus. We seem to have a remarkable capacity to stir ourselves up just by thinking about it.

Anyway, the result of this occurring is that many deep emotive processes can become frozen in a kind of fixated state, and that our capacity to adapt in a fluid manner can be dramatically affected as a result. The core becomes crippled. The consequences of this, in relation to what we have been discussing, are simple- If any element of integrity or healthy functioning has been negated in order to suspend a deep emotive process, then in seeking to restore that integrity you will inevitably be led to address the underlying issue it is 'containing'. You see, the rift between surface and core creates a kind of gap, a void in feeling, and that space is not simply empty. It is full of baggage, and

- if what we presume about its origins is correct - was created specifically to store that baggage. Meaning that to restore integrity between surface and core will naturally displace whatever is existing in that void.

These suspended processes don't just go away, no matter how long you wait. Such processes represent the system's primary integrity, and whilst you can assault an organic system's integrity, you can't actually remove it. It is built in. Thus, if suspended, these processes simply back up and build up. And what this means is that in seeking to restore greater integrity to that frontal-core relationship, we may inevitably be led to address some degree of fixation or dysfunction at this deeper level within ourselves. In this light we can see that the basic core-surface breach could function as a kind of 'king pin' for a whole bundle of repressive mechanisms. You never know what it might be containing or allowing to go unfinished. It involves a basic limitation on feeling, and a distortion of primary integrity. Which is why, in re-establishing this particular aspect of systemic integrity, we can often end up inadvertently biting off somewhat more than we bargained for. Because with any return of primary integrity between core and surface, and the depth of feeling associated, we get the return of many other elements of functioning which were lost or suspended when this inner connection was severed. And with all of this, we get trouble. A whole new ball game. And this, I believe, is what people are really afraid of.

Most people don't like to entertain the idea that they may be harbouring 'repression' in some sense, but this is exactly the implication. Far more than we generally acknowledge, at least that is the common presumption of those who work in this area. It seems to be well accepted that our unconscious is a regular repository for such 'unfinished business'. And the reason we seek to

avoid these processes in ourselves? Perhaps because, whilst these deep emotive processes serve a vital function, they are often experienced as somewhat uncomfortable in the middle stages. Meaning that they are resisted. The fact that many cultures and family systems condemn or disallow the natural expression which accompanies these emotive processes could also be a compounding factor. At least, up until now, nothing else seems to explain why there is so much of this kind of thing lurking around in our unconscious selves.

What all this means, then, is that to the degree such suspended processes are present within us due to historical impacts to our emotive core, that we will almost certainly be confronted with them as we seek to restore depth and connection within our own inner world. This seems unavoidable. And unfortunately, as we saw earlier, the more inept we are, the more we will have to work through. Meaning that those who are most afraid of change, usually have the most to do. For in their case there are half finished processes of deep emotive change backed up to the hilt. And the more repressed we are, generally, the less capable of appropriately handling these experiences. We retreat in fear. Fear, essentially, of change. All of which might prompt us to say- 'Why would you bother? Let sleeping dogs lie!' Which is quite understandable in many ways. For one thing, as these processes are re-awakened they are not exactly orderly. A messy business to be sure! There is always an underlying integrity, but it's often not very evident at the time. Sometimes the changes these 'frozen' processes were originally affecting are now redundant and way out of date, and the system just needs to thaw them out and clear them out of the 'pipeline' so to speak. Like an emotional vomit. A purge. So it might seem a bit uncomfortable, but the prospect of simply leaving all this stagnant water hanging around is also not very attractive in the long term. It has more than a few negative consequences.

You see it's not like we would have to do something to dredge these things up in ourselves, it's that we are doing things to keep them down. All this stuff is not just passively 'sleeping' as we might presume. It is being actively held at bay, and the continuation of that holding is a demanding process, albeit an unconsciously motivated one. Our system's underlying integrity asserts itself automatically and relentlessly. Meaning that in the right positive circumstances, these suspended processes will simply re-animate quite by themselves and begin moving toward their own resolution. That is their nature, they were never meant to stand still. And in such a situation we can become full of emotional tension for no apparent reason, which will often drive us toward inappropriate forms of expression as we blame any number of external factors for our state. Without understanding, we can become 'grumpy', self destructive, and abusive of others as we discharge our stress in inappropriate ways. We may even know we do it, but just can't do anything about it. So eventually, in order to avoid this kind of overloading, we are forced to avoid many healthy states. Which, even if it is largely unconscious, is a remarkably sophisticated achievement, given that our entire organism is naturally oriented toward finding healthy states. All of which means a continual effort, like holding a beach ball under water. Our system is effectively forced to fight itself, to confront its own powerful integrity.

The result of this, in emotional terms, is that we tend to avoid many aspects of healthy functioning simply because they can have the effect of re-animating some of these old and uncomfortable processes. Because they mysteriously make us 'feel bad'. And one of those aspects of healthy functioning happens to be the re-establishment of elementary integrity between the core and surface levels of ourselves. Exactly what we've been discussing. So, to extend felt awareness toward

your core animates change. Meaning that many things which should naturally make us feel good, tend to have the opposite effect. Precisely because they are healthy and normal. All of which produces stress and, ultimately, 'mysterious unhappiness'.

The benefits of restoring integrity should not be overlooked however, even if it is initially uncomfortable or disconcerting. For one thing, the whole process of continually avoiding our own natural tendency toward healthy states is a heavy load to carry. The unconscious agenda responsible for avoiding these 'dreaded' feelings works independently to the conscious persona, and often in direct opposition to it. Which creates a very basic division of power in the system, placing direct limits on our creative potential - our capacity to create the life we desire. So re-connecting with these dissociated aspects of ourselves is to recover much creative power. To see this more clearly we need only examine the primary function of the core itself, the thing all this inner struggle is acting to avoid. The core, in its free and healthy state, is the very root of all creative power. It is the animating force, the driving engines. The core is the mainline creative force, our inbuilt power source, and to allow fear to deny it a voice is to invite inertia and passivity into your life. But, admittedly, the whole prospect can be a bit scary. And much of the fear surrounding deep emotive processes is natural and understandable, but perhaps does not reflect the actual dangers involved.

Let me explain- Imagine holding your thumb over the end of a running hose, because - at some point - you had reason to fear the water [water, in this case, being deep emotive process and your capacity to feel]. We are now left in a dilemma- If we continue to cap the hose, what we feel is building pressure, and begin to suffer from the continually increasing effort involved. It is also a dilemma because a

limitation on feeling is ultimately a limitation on vitality and happiness. We instinctively want to release our grip. But if we even tentatively release it, just a bit, the first thing that happens is that we get high pressure spray in our face, in all directions, confirming our prior suspicions that feeling is dangerous and not to be trusted. Our immediate and obvious perception is that the water is uncontrollable, and that if you let your thumb right off the hose, you would risk being uncontrollably flooded. Flooded with uncontrollable feelings. Nevertheless, what we don't see from this tentative experience is that the water is actually just a healthy trickle, and that it is your thumb - your resistance - which has produced the pressure and the erratic spray.

A Fish Out of Water

Before we leave this subject and move on, there is one more serious factor worth addressing, one more thing which can represent a considerable obstacle to what we have been discussing. Which is this- If what I have outlined here really is a definition of natural and healthy functioning, then it seems pretty clear that many elements of common culture are not. That culture is directly opposed to the basic orientation it suggests, implying that, at least in this sense, common culture is not as healthy and natural as we might wish. The reason for this probably lies in the fact that the kind of repression we are indicating here is so prevalent, and that common culture is often set up to serve the lowest common denominator.

In some ways we can see two distinct orientations here, especially concerning how we relate to our own core self. And it is easy to see how each might well support a different kind of culture. Because each supports a different core state, and different outward expressions. We have already seen that

healthy functioning at the core naturally results in certain expressions at the surface. That core and surface are connected in this way. But the same is also true of dysfunctional core behaviour, that it also has certain outward components. As already stated, bent people create bent environments in order to make themselves appear straighter. Dysfunctional individuals always find or create dysfunctional culture in order to feel comfortable. And common culture would appear to be such a structure. Anyone seeking to maintain the suspension of deep emotive processes in themselves must act to avoid any circumstances in which that suspension might become threatened. Which basically means avoiding particular healthy activities or states, because these processes already know their own way home, they need only be allowed. So it is the function of common culture to prevent this, and thus allow everyone to operate within comfortable, if somewhat dysfunctional, limits. And this is something which reflects itself at many levels, including the way family structures are arranged. It means that any group of people with one orientation would organise themselves in very different ways to a group displaying the other orientation. There are obviously many shades of grey between completely dysfunctional and completely healthy, but when viewed in black and white terms these two cultures would create very different sets of boundaries and social injunctions. Different should's and shouldn't's, do's and do-not's, must's and must-not's. And this is because there is a natural integrity or connectedness between surface and core. Which means that, because these two core orientations are directly opposed, we can expect the same of the cultural structures they support.

An example of this is intimacy. We are a highly social animal, perhaps due to our own evolutionary history. Much of our psychological and emotional

functioning is tuned to operate in a close social context. Meaning that, at least to some degree, we do much of our healing and feeling in direct relation to others. And this process is what we call intimacy. To be intimate is simply to expose yourself to someone, to go within yourself and express what you find without fear or judgement. With this in mind, intimacy could be described as one of the primary mainstays of natural and healthy psychological and emotional functioning. For whilst it is ostensibly a sharing of oneself with another, it is also - in the process - a journey of self discovery and integration. In showing others who we truly are, we very often find things out for ourselves. We actively strengthen, expand and maintain our own inner connectedness to ourselves. And this is what scares many. Because - like many other healthy potentials - intimacy not only allows inner depth, but actively enforces it. Meaning that in this sharing, in showing ourselves to others, we are also tapping our own depths. Which is no problem if we accept, and have feeling access to, the deeper realities of ourselves, for we are naturally able to expose these to others in environments which are safe to do so. But when some degree of depth is lost, or if we are seeking to avoid ourselves in the sense we have been defining above, then this can be embarrassing. So what we see is the emergence of social contexts devoid of any of the essential factors required for truly healthy and regenerative interaction between people. Intimacy, in particular, becomes profoundly threatening. It is threatening and invasive, even when it is passive. Simply because a healthy social environment acts to support healthy emotional functioning, it means that repressed people are assaulted from within in such a situation. And the result of this is that a healthy orientation toward intimacy and emotional expression becomes deeply offensive to those struggling to maintain the denial which naturally accompanies repression.

The point here is that we tend to choose social environments which reflect our own inner state of being. And that if we have much in the way of unfinished emotional process, we will tend to find or create social environments which not only passively avoid pointing this out, but which actively prevent such from ever being pointed out. We will not be able to exist comfortably in a positive social environment. In this way, shallow people sentence themselves to a life in which they can only relate in shallow ways. They seek out birds of a feather. And, in some ways, our entire common culture has taken on these characteristics. Perhaps, as I said, because this dysfunctional orientation is so prevalent in our society. But it could also be argued that this orientation is so prevalent precisely because our culture displays these characteristics. That it has arisen and been perfected and refined over millennia to reflect the common individual. That it is a social structure expressly designed to strategically avoid certain healthy processes in anyone who adheres to its axioms. That it tacitly supports such avoidance. That amongst other mechanisms, it even ignores and denies the very existence of these processes, and the realms in which they exist.

The outcome of this is that common culture does not support what we have been discussing. In fact, more than this, it outright condemns it in many ways. You see, whilst dysfunctional culture may allow dysfunctional individuals to feel safe and comfortable in their disease, it also has the effect of enforcing that dysfunction and entrenching it. The very same integrity between surface and core - the means by which the healthy core directs outward behaviour etc - also means that surface behaviour can affect core functioning - that surface oppression can create core repression. And this is where we see once again how the most deeply corrupt forms of dysfunction are the most likely to

be transmitted. Precisely because of the power dysfunctional culture has to corrupt individual functioning. A social environment can deeply affect a person's core. And this is what we are up against. If a member from one group was transplanted and immersed in the other, over time their core state would be affected over time. Either positively or negatively according to their environment. They reflect it directly over time. Which means that common culture, to the degree it is dysfunctional, has become a vehicle by which dysfunction is perpetuated and even enforced. Individuals create culture, but culture also has a profound influence over individuals.

The unfortunate consequence of all this, then, is that in making this gradual transition in yourself, you will not only become disillusioned with common culture, but also threatening to it. Common culture has become a safe place for those who are seeking to hide from themselves, and from others. Thus, healthy people naturally produce a kind of subculture. A secret world almost, which common culture can neither see nor understand. After all, what you can't see in yourself, you can't see in another. To understand depth in others, you must first find it in yourself. And this is the point I am getting to here- That to make this shift in yourself is also to shift between these two cultures. Like being awake in a room full of sleeping people who do not want to be disturbed, to choose this path is to place yourself in a distinct minority. You will be entering a subculture, and will have to find refuge on one of the small but growing islands of healthy culture in this sea of dysfunction. And the more depth you recover, the smaller your peer group will become. You will lose friends. You will, merely by being yourself, become profoundly threatening, precisely because you will become an intrinsically healing person to be around, without even trying. You will lose friends, maybe even family. This seems almost

unavoidable. Shallow is of no interest to those who have made such a transition. positively oriented individuals cannot freely express themselves naturally in a negative social circumstance without deeply offending those present, and thus terminating contact. They must play-act shallowness. But you will also discover new levels of vulnerability, intimacy and integrity you did not know existed. you will naturally begin relating in new ways, ways closer to the natural human norm.

Common culture will lose its meaning. The denial confronted in shallow common culture, whilst it works for those engaging in it, will no longer function to convince you. To anyone who has chosen to return to themselves, and to restore their natural depth and flow, shallow people become transparent, and their delusions obvious. And to shallow people, these healthy people become offensive people, precisely because they see straight through their self delusions to what is really happening within them. In fact, in certain circumstances, I believe it is entirely possible to know more about what someone is feeling than they know for themselves, simply because they are not listening. So merely by being healthy, a person can break unspoken rules, violate silent and invisible treaties, and in some very real sense become the 'enemy'. Precisely because the common individual is disturbed in this way, the orientation we are discussing is disturbing. Because it threatens the status quo.

In the end, then, what we see here is another whole level to the question we were addressing above of resolving the rift between surface and core. And we also see some of the possible causes of that rift.

Which leaves us with this conclusion: That in order to re-connect surface to core, we must also become adept at flowing with the changes the core represents, including being prepared to address

and allow any stranded deep emotive processes to progress toward resolution. We see that the re-emergence of these suspended processes is simply a natural by-product of the return of systemic equanimity and integrity. Life is simply easier without having to avoid them. It is simply easier to be who you really are. And as time goes by, anyone who gains sufficient confidence in 'releasing their thumb' eventually has less and less back pressure to deal with, and more and more experience of easy flow. It becomes recognised that in every moment of time you are either getting closer or further away from this potential of depth and flow, and the closer you get, the easier it becomes. So as this transition gradually occurs, fear of these deep processes falls away. Those with the courage to persist eventually find that the kind of emotive processes which 'freaked them out' to begin with become 'par for the course', and tend to find resolution more easily. They soon realise that it is resistance which hurts, not emotion.

These processes are the 'panel beaters' of the core, and an inner trust returns as these functions become recognised as doing vital work. Depth returns to life, and to our sense of being. We can feel again, and that is worth everything. Feeling is the essential function which keeps us in touch with change, and with ourselves. Thus, the universal message of all modern psychology: feelings are not all as evil as you think. Each element of suspended process has an aspect of our true self held in its grasp. If allowed, all these functions will eventually clear the backlog and straighten themselves out, once again becoming a natural and integral part of healthy life. Re-connecting ourselves to ourselves. Depth and feeling once again becomes ordinary and silent as we learn to flow and surrender. The thumb is off the hose, and the natural quiet flow of change resumes.

What we see here, then, is the backdrop for the second main path taken on the inner front. That of confronting and bringing to 'closure' processes in ourselves which were once started, but never finished. Thus purging ourselves of the residual effects of historical impacts to our emotive core. And this whole approach or philosophy has produced many branches of therapeutic modality over time, both mainstream and alternative. From the twelve steps of AA, to 'primal therapy', to the so-called 'men's movement'. From the entire 'recovery culture', to rebirthing, to hypno, and the incredible boom in popular psychotherapy and analysis. And many many others, Neurosis itself has been described as our system's own attempts at resolving the tensions associated with these ruptures. Entire industries thrive on assisting people with dealing with this.⁴ They all have different explanations, but it's the same stuff they're all dealing with in the end. Choose your poison. And they all represent a certain common 'wisdom' which has developed, characterised in an essential trust of our inner processes. In fact, in many ways 'therapy' could be characterised as merely an isolated environment. A micro-culture, in which the dysfunctional rules and injunctions of common culture can be suspended, and healthy ones restored. Meaning it is often a matter, not of what happens in that environment, but rather what doesn't happen - ie leave common culture at the door. A therapeutic environment is simply a small island of healthy social relationships in a sea of dysfunction. And all you learn there is how normal healthy relating works, with others and with

⁴ Books to read on this stuff? Thousands! So many approaches.....

'The New Primal Scream' - Dr. A. Janof.

'Shame and Guilt' - Moddleton-Moz.

'The Drama of the Gifted Child' - Alice Miller.

'The Gestalt Approach & Eye Witness to Therapy' -Fritz Perls M.D., Ph.D

'Boienergetics' -Alexander Lowen, M.D.

'The Holotropic Mind' - Stanislav Grof, M.D.

Really, you'll find whole sections on this stuff in any progressive bookstore.

yourself. The value of such being in the transfer of that back to your broader life. The other implication of this is that if we lived in a healthy culture, therapeutic environments would be unnecessary.

So do I agree then? Does all this work? Is all this well and good? Well.....yes, and no. I agree in principle, that this is all heading in the right direction. But not with common explanations as to the origins and nature of all this, nor with the practical outcomes such theories produce when applied. I believe almost all such approaches suffer greatly from having incomplete knowledge of what they are dealing with, and that their results reflect this. Even that, because of this, in some respects our negative cultural response may be quite valid. So all this brings up a lot of big questions, many of which we will not get a chance to finally address until much later in this work.

A couple of obvious ones are –

The first issue all this raises for me is that of *validation*. Which means the way people explain the origins of this stuff in ourselves. All these ‘suspended processes’ represent, on an emotional level, the evidence of some kind of historical *wounding*. Meaning repression of this nature is generally considered to be the result of trauma of some kind, and the processes themselves to be the system’s own healing functions. But what could possibly have caused such? Because, causes aside for a moment, it would seem that these suspended processes were significant enough to have been considered a serious threat to the system. Which would indicate considerable gravity indeed. And this is an issue because there is a very strong need to find *reasons* when dealing with these issues, especially in contexts which require this, such as formal analysis.

The individual themselves often requires such validation to make sense of the whole process of recovery. But, in general, these processes remain an enigma. As I said, '*that*' these processes are there is generally accepted, but '*why*' they are there is still largely a mystery. Precisely because in the process of having been repressed, the cognitive elements of the original experience are often negated or lost.

Many stories have emerged over time to account for this content in our subconscious beings. And in a therapeutic environment, especially on the basis of subtle suggestion, it has been proven that the mind can simply generate or fabricate an entire historical context to fit whatever emotional content is being experienced. Which creates the problem—People are experiencing *real* trauma, *real* emotions, and *real* recovery. But the causes they often attribute to these traumas are sometimes exaggerated or even completely fallacious. That they *believe* them is undoubted, but whether they *actually occurred* in the manner they describe is often very questionable indeed. So it would seem that in finding the *validation* needed to heal such deep emotional processes, people are sometimes crying wolf and making accusations about their history which are simply not founded. This need for validation has led, at times, to a kind of social hysteria, which is usually then deflated by more substantive methods of inquiry which debunk their central claims.

In my opinion there are some very good reasons for the existence of much of this stuff within us, reasons which fully account for their valance and scope, and we will come to them in section three. Historically, however, an excessive level of blame has often been levelled at dysfunctional families as the cause, and at parents in particular. Implying that some form of subtle or gross abandonment had occurred, which is often supported by

whatever memories are recovered in the process itself. But even this, in many cases, is still hard to support, even theoretically. And so the rise of social myths occurs. Myths arise when culture does not support or validate aspects of real, but subjective, experience in its members, as a way of giving meaning and a sense of shared experience. After all, the subjective elements of these stories *are* real. The emotional elements and trauma. Valid socially, but quite false aetiologically.

In this context then, possibly through suggestion in the media, we saw massive surges in *ritual*, *sexual* or *satanic* abuse being 'remembered' when the recovery movement first gained popularity. And when many of those claims were debunked, hey, it was the *aliens*, yeah, the *aliens* did it to me! If it's not swings, it's roundabouts. I just can't wait to see what pops up next. So *validation* remains a problem. Because these very real subjective 'symptoms' are still struggling to find appropriate 'causes' without unfounded allegations being made in the process.

Then there is the matter of *resolution*. Is pursuing this kind of thing really worth it? Does it really heal or resolve anything? Once again, the unanimous cry of all therapy modalities is - YES! But they would say that wouldn't they. And once again I have serious reservations based on direct observation of many people in the before, during and after stages of such 'therapy'. Clearly, good work is often done, but there are certainly some pretty serious negative potentials inherent in such a process. There are many ideas to explain the nature and origin of these processes within us and what should be done with them, but the results of the application of such are, unfortunately, often not as clinically tidy as the theories. So I'll leave that question open at this stage. But needless to say, not all is well here.

Lastly there is the whole issue of how *prevalent* this stuff is. Of how many of us suffer from carrying such emotional baggage, and how much. The therapists tend to say it's everyone, but once again, I'm not so sure. If you weren't massively traumatised as a child, there's really no reason you'd necessarily carry such to any great degree. But still, this is the therapist's globalised view I'm questioning here, I do still believe this kind of stuff remains far more prevalent than most people assume. And I could go on, there are other issues, but once again they will be picked up later as we go.

In summary -

There are deep emotive processes at work to protect and repair our core, and the suspension of these processes can be the origin of the rift between surface and core. Meaning that in order to recover our natural connection with our core, we must go through cleaning up any unfinished business such uncovers, allowing any suspended processes to progress toward resolution and closure. The connection between core and surface is what we call 'feeling'. So as part of the process of establishing for ourselves a healthy and accurate self expression, and recovering our capacity to feel deeply, we are often faced with the prospect of clearing what can sometimes seem like a bottomless pit of 'emotional baggage'. Adding another dimension to the whole process we are outlining so far.

So what does this mean in plain language? That you could be faced with the emergence of old hurts you thought you had forgotten and left behind. That, to the degree such active repression is present, you could once again be led to re-address aspects of your own history in order to free up your present and future. This would seem unavoidable.

These are the two main issues thus far –

- **The rift between core and surface.**
- **And the neglected state of the core itself.**

Both, apparently, significant and lasting causes of personal unhappiness, and both requiring processes of personal change to address. It could also be said that they can be considered two aspects of what is actually a single ongoing process of change or ‘personal development’. Quite rightly so perhaps, because of the inherent connection between the two. And they are, on the inner front, our culture’s most travelled path so to speak.

Want it even simpler? –

- **Be who you are, fly your true colours. Express your core.**
- **Allow yourself to change and grow, which will be the natural result of intimacy, of opening yourself up to others. Let your core change.**

Cultural Debates

Adding to the debate concerning the reality of change in life, we can see another age old question being raised here. The general orientation all this suggests regarding our inner selves is the focus of considerable debate and discussion. Does wellbeing and happiness issue from the outside-in, or the inside-out? We find ourselves questioning the cultural assertion that happiness is somehow able to be simply imposed by the force of will alone. That to simply ‘be happy’ on the surface has some capacity to improve life, that to smile is in

some way to be happy; that true positivity can simply be asserted at a surface level. I can hear Judy Garland singing it now- “....put on a happy face....” [She was, by all accounts, a very unhappy person.]

And we are led to question this here because the whole proposition we’ve been addressing thus far runs directly contrary to such an assertion. It is a view which seems to suggest that such imposition - any surface imposition which is contrary to the actual core state - is actually, by definition, the very cause of unhappiness. That affirming the positive and repressing the negative are exactly the same thing, merely expressed in different terms. Both requiring effort and energy, and representing a direct breach of primary integrity. The assumption we are led to then, is that if there is negativity at the core, then there is probably a very good reason for it. And that the way to address that negativity is to flow with it, not act against it. To follow it to wherever it may happen to take us, and let it do its job.

Let everything be allowed to do what it naturally does, so its nature will be satisfied.

- Chuang Tzu

This is a very broad question then. Should we submit and flow, or impose and regulate? And it is an argument which ultimately boils down to an even deeper issue regarding the value of feelings and emotions, and allowing ourselves to be governed by them. It seems clear that both of the processes we have covered seem to strongly favour a trust of, and submission to, what we find within. In fact, if we look closely, we see two distinct philosophical issues emerging here, both very practical issues -

- **The first** is whether we should trust and follow what we feel, what we just ‘know’, and

let such direct us in life. Should we flow with our deeper energies and impulses as they arise? Connect with, and move to, our own deeper rhythm, and let these energies direct the flow of change in life?

- **The second** relates to the value of deep emotive processes [of grief especially] in life? Whether we should allow them? Express them? And submit to them? Should we let them come, flow with them, and allow them to be embraced?

Both of which clearly bring to the fore our culture's general orientation toward emotion and feelings et al. Both of the issues above are seriously questioned in our current society. In fact, in order to assume any position of significant responsibility in our culture, we are often expressly tested for the very capacity to over-ride what we feel in favour of reason or some set protocol. Tested for the capacity to rise above mere emotive functions, because such rising above is a capacity which is considered a distinct virtue, and a sign of true maturity. Leaving emotions themselves generally considered as a distinct form of personal weakness.

The big question then, a question both of these approaches ask, can be boiled down to this- Should we trust and follow what we feel? Should we submit to our own deeper energies, and allow emotion to flow and move us? And we will come back to this question again by the end of this section, so for now let's turn our attention to the other main approach our culture supports, and see if it fares any better than the one we just covered.

Second Half: Outward

DO YOUR DREAM

May you live all the days of your life.

- Jonathan Swift

*Go confidently in the direction of your dreams.
Live the life you have imagined.*

- Henry David Thoreau

WHAT ARE you looking for? Are you living the life you always desired? Do you even know what that life is? Happiness, it is commonly presumed, is simply a matter of desire over satisfaction. Knowing what you want, and getting it. This is a worldview our current society adheres to very firmly, and which produces almost everything we see around us as culture and civilisation.

We all agree that happiness and desire would seem to have some intrinsic connection. Even that happiness is, broadly speaking, simply the fulfilment of desire. We all seem to presume this, but very few of us ever really apply this in practice. We don't all champion our truest desires, and pursue them with passion. At least not fully or without reservation.

So what does it take? And what would happen if we did apply this ethos fully?

There would seem to be only two basic parts to this approach, I mean...how hard could it be? Desire + satisfaction = happiness. Really, this is what the common presumption prescribes, it's supposedly just that simple. So, with this in mind, the remainder of this section will be devoted to examining the process of **defining** what you want, and the process of **getting** it. Simple. Easy!

Did I hear a groan?

As we now turn our attentions outward, we might presume that we would be leaving all that inner stuff behind and moving on to something a bit more concrete. However, this is not the case as it turns out. If you examine everything we covered in the first half of this section, you will see that the core itself is designed to influence the frontal persona, and for a good reason. We see that it is in fact focused beyond that, in the world of transactions and outer circumstances. That the frontal self is actually caught between these two - the emotive core and the relational world. It is a bridge, and should ideally be securely connected at both ends. In fact all the inner functioning we have addressed ultimately relates to what could be called **change management**.

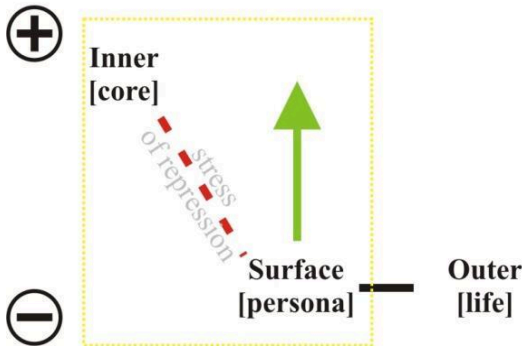
This can be seen as the function of all higher capacities - The maintenance of an outward circumstance which reflects the truth and needs of the system as a whole. And it is via this bridge that the core directs change so as to be in keeping with the true and authentic interests of the organism. In fact the core is not really interested in the frontal persona at all, provided it does its job. Core energies are meant to be expressed in the world,

that is their purpose, the frontal persona merely delivers them.

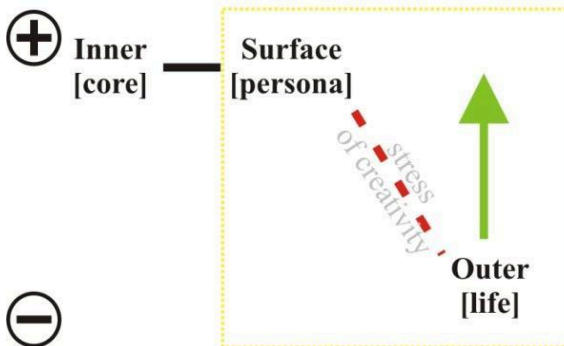
In this context it becomes clearer what the reasons could be for the stress associated with restoring our felt inner connection to our core. In overall terms, it is not so much the rupture between surface and core that causes core stress, but the relationship between inner core and outer circumstance. The connection between core and surface is the means by which the organism keeps outward circumstances in alignment with its needs and requirements. So the inner rupture we addressed in the first half of this section is damaging because it allows outer circumstances to degenerate and move out of kilter with our underlying character over time. Thus, in restoring that inner connection, we generally experience stress. Not as a result of misalignment between core and persona, but because that broken connection has allowed outer circumstances to move out of alignment with the core's desires. The stress is the result of the circumstances the core now faces due to the poor change management which has occurred whilst it has been 'off line' so to speak. Thus, those stresses are simply the emotional component of functional tensions which naturally press for immediate change and realignment of circumstances to better fit who we are. So what we advocated in the first half of this section means not only accepting who we are, but also adapting to that in outer life. To find an overall circumstance in life which reflects our true inner nature. Which means that in restoring inner integrity, we automatically find ourselves turning our attention outward and making changes. This is unavoidable, simply because this is exactly what the core pushes for, because this is precisely what it does. That is its job, to protect us and keep us in a situation which honours and respects who we are. So what we have already studied are problems which can arise within us to afflict this bridge at the inner end. And

now, in turning our attention outward, we merely find ourselves extending that bridge and thus finishing the job we started.

In the first half we saw this -



And now we complete it with this -



What we must realise is that it is misalignment between inner and outer which produces stress. The surface persona is simply caught in the middle. All inner functioning ultimately relates to

outer change via pressure on the frontal from the core. And it is when the core and the outer circumstance move out of alignment that the 'frontal self' experiences stress, provided that it is connected to the core and has not ruptured the bridge at the inner end. Thus any change inwardly to restore that connection and flow inevitably has profound effects outwardly, because the frontal self ends up with its hands full of packages to deliver. The practical result of which is what we now find ourselves looking at - outer change. That in restoring our connection inwardly, we are led to address the very real process of creating for yourself a life which reflects your core. In other words, the life you desire. Which is essentially what we will be studying here.

*What we are basically addressing, then, as I mentioned - is **change management**. And I need to make one thing clear at the outset - in the name of 'personal change' many seek to merely alter their perception, to find ways of feeling better about the same reality, the same old life. And that this is not what I will be addressing. I am talking about real change here, actual change. Although, as we will see in what follows, affecting such does often demand and involve significant inner change.*

The Creative Process

Change management can effectively be viewed as little more than a series of creative acts all woven together into a continuous stream. Meaning that, in a very real sense, what we are studying here is simply the nature of any creative act. For in any single strand we can see the substance of the whole. And any act of creation has three aspects -

1.
Creative-formative-inspiring

[defining the destination]

2.

Planning-organisational
[defining the path]

3.

Implementation-finalising
[walking the path]

These are universal. As individuals, we must develop all three primary creative functions if we are going to fulfil our creative potential, and a failure in any one will limit the effectiveness of the other two, affecting the process as a whole. These three are the golden triangle of effective creating. Together, these functions comprise our essential 'creative anatomy' so to speak.

And, once again, you might think that because we have moved our attention outwards, that we would be spending most of our time looking at steps two and three, both of which are directly outward focussed. But not so. It is actually the first formative function which is often dramatically lacking, undervalued or misunderstood. And once again, we see that it is largely internal in nature.

The result is that we will be spending most of our time here addressing only the first of these three essential creative functions, and only as it relates to personal change management or 'life creation'. There are good reasons for focusing on this function specifically. In terms of creative sequence, if you look at these two factors - the defining and the getting - and the relationship they have in practice, you'll see that one always precedes the other. That before you can create [or maintain] something, you've first got to know what it is. You've got to have a clear idea, at least in some core sense. Clear intention, clear outcome. Fuzzy intention, fuzzy outcome. Conflicted intention,

ineffectual outcome. Vague or no intention, random outcome. I hope this is not too obvious.

You have to know what you want in this life, or you can't get it. How are you going to figure out how to get what you want if you don't know what that is? We live as if we know this, it is amazing how we think or presume that we know this, when in fact we very often don't. A fact which can easily be confirmed by simply asking anyone to define it in clear terms. And this is of such great importance because if you are confused about what you want – and most people are – then your chances of getting it are severely diminished, if not entirely eliminated. Most people think that if only they were presented with what they want, that they would recognise it. But if that were so, then they should be able to feel within themselves and produce some picture of what it would be in essence, and this seems to be very difficult to do. So this is, I believe, where the common approach generally comes unstuck most of the time, in the defining end, rather than the acquiring one. A 'magic wand' is useless, if you don't know what to create with it.

As it turns out, fortunately, this is also the only one of these three which is open to specific definition. What we are talking about here is defining the sum total of a person's present desires, for such is what represents the total of our creative force in life. And although the process of defining a desire is essentially common to all, involving the same basic factors, from there onward in the sequence the process is always completely unique. Because everyone desires, but each individual's particular desires will be different – a reflection of the person and their particular circumstance. And so the process of actual creation, the getting bit, is always completely original and unique to each person. So there is really not much I can do to help beyond a certain point. But as we'll see, the 'what' and the

'how' are actually inherently connected anyway, and that in sorting this one out we may just fix them both - that in the very process of correctly defining what you want may actually initiate functions which eventually result in its creation. Unavoidably even. But hey, I'm jumping the gun a bit here.

*If what I am asserting here is accurate, then, that the main problem lies in the defining side rather than the achieving side, then the following would seem to make sense- that if someone can concretely define, in essence, what it is that they truly desire in life, then they may **massively** increase their chances of actually realising that. And thus, presumably, equally increase their chances of **happiness**.*

The driving force

So what does it mean to define what you desire in life? The main issues afflicting this would seem to be either a lack of clarity, and/or the presence of outright conflict. And if we start with the assumption that true desires represent something in us which has integrity, then both of these indicate a third and more significant issue- that the 'desires' we think we have already are not actually founded in the system's true emotive core. That they are not true desires, just fanciful ideas. The result of which is a profound lack of creative power.

So what does that mean- truly desire? Aren't all desires true? Surely, if I say I want it, then I want it? Right? Well, this brings us back to some of the issues introduced in the first half, and down to the very question of what a desire actually is.

To review: The emotive core produces inner tensions which have the function of animating the frontal self and thus producing change outwardly in the realm of relational exchange with the environment. These energies, and the systems which produce them, are expressly designed to determine the flow of change in our lives. This is their very purpose for existing. From the standpoint of the conscious self, these subjective tensions represent continual emotional feedback, our own inner compass, directed by the core. Some schools of psychology have sometimes called this feedback 'cathexis'. Defining such as an 'emotional charge' - either positive or negative - which your emotive core ascribes to certain objects and relational exchanges in your environment. This 'charge' is also what sorts out the foreground from the background in any situation, by directing attention and making certain things 'pop out' at us. Anyway, negative cathexis is reflected in - amongst other things - repulsion and aversion. Positive cathexis, conversely, in attraction and desire. These energies are our driving engines, our motive force, and as such they are also our natural power to create [or destroy]. They are our inbuilt change generators. Our very source of creative power. And cathexis itself is a product of the emotive core, ONLY the emotive core.

True desire, then, is not just an idea, not just some fancy or whim. True desire is a coupling of surface and core, and when you remove the core element it stands the risk of it becoming both impotent, and inappropriate. Without this anchor, it is no longer directed by anything deeper, nor supported by anything deeper. Not true desire at all, just an arbitrary idea. The core is like the conductor of an orchestra, it is the integrating factor which brings it all together. And thus, desires formed under such circumstances, as well as being almost powerless, do not reflect any underlying integrity or overall design, and are prone to being scattered and

lacking in cohesion. Just a jumbled mixed bag of odds and sods, rather than a well orchestrated symphony of true creative force. So desire, at a cognitive level - if it is true desire - always represents an energetic concomitant at a deeper level. In the same way that an elected official represents the interests of those who give them a mandate. And just so, if an elected official loses touch with those being represented, they lose their mandate, and their creating power. They are no longer supported or backed up by any real underlying power base. The same applies to desire.

True desire, then, is a representation at the surface, of a tension generated at the core, for the core's purposes. The core, you see, has a job to do. It holds significant responsibilities, and this is how it fulfils them. It knows that we will always be motivated toward a tension free state, so it generates emotion as leverage. Which brings us back to what we have already been discussing- That to recover a truly healthy and responsive relationship to our own core, should naturally result in two things worth having - stable need fulfilment, and freedom from emotional tension. Which, if you look at them, pretty much equate to what we call happiness.

Bearing all this in mind, it seems reasonable enough to presume that what we saw in the last half of this section could be some of the reasons this process could be getting a bit slowed down: that the foundations of desire are in realms of pure feeling, and people are often not honouring the integrity which is supposed to exist between surface and core. And in keeping with the denial this implies concerning our deeper natures, they are seeking to simply decide what they want instead. Leaving their so-called desires free of any real substance.

So this is what I mean by true desire, desire founded in the core itself, not just made up on the basis of some fancy or prejudice, or because

someone says you 'should' want this or that. And this is just one of a few places where the first half of this section weaves in with the second half. The two approaches each half represents do in fact work together and support each other. Actually, just like the two processes in the first half were really one, just so, the first and second halves of this entire section can be viewed as one seamless process. If only because desire is essentially an energetic coupling of surface and core, and because any approach based on desire would inevitably be prone to suffer from the kind of core-surface rift we addressed on the 'inner' front. Meaning that everything we outlined in the first half are good examples of the kinds of things which can obstruct what we are talking about there. And both ends of this section also seem to support and reflect the same basic orientation toward deep inner processes and realities. Which is essentially a process of trust, of listening and submitting, rather than telling and imposing and dominating. Not what many are used to for sure. It is an orientation which defines 'You', the frontal personality, as the servant, not the master.

In light of the nature of desire, then, we can see here that to regain any degree of 'feeling access' or connection between surface and core, as I described earlier, is to essentially regain our 'inner compass' as it were. Good communication between surface and core is the essential capacity required to define what it is you truly desire in life. Which, in turn, seems to be the essential capacity required in order to actually acquire and maintain such.

Without this essential source of inner direction we have no option but to look outside ourselves for guidance, we generally adopt some codified model of behaviour against which we then judge ourselves. Which means that instead of simply doing and being what we want in life - because we don't know what that is - we end up doing what we are 'supposed' to do instead, what we 'should' do,

and like vultures preying on the weak, there are always people ready and willing to tell us what this might be. So to live without our inner compass is often to be subject to the dictates of others, and the limitations this implies. I call this getting your injunctional 'mail' from the 'spost box'. 'Spost' to do this, and 'spost' to do that... another result of the lack of primary responsibility we discussed in the last half, of still looking to others for primary support and direction. Whether it be society or family or a single individual you are appealing to, it makes little difference really. To look outside yourself in defining what you want in life is to be perpetually lost and imprisoned by someone else's history and agenda. It is to be stuck with always wearing a 'mask' that doesn't fit who you really are. And it is also to deny ourselves the dynamic creating power which can only come from the core.

Trust

It is a nice thought to believe that this is the way things could work in practice, but can we really trust our own inner core to steer us in the right direction? Well, if happiness truly is a matter of desire over satisfaction, and if true desire really does only come from the core, then I guess we have no choice. Just the way nature intended things, it would seem.

Where, then, does all this leave us? First of all with this simple realisation – If you can't feel, you can't formulate true and active desire. For it is the feeling aspect, the emotive charge, the energetic component, which gives desire both its systemic integrity and its creative potency.

So the conclusion thus far? Dare to *Feel* and to *Follow*.

Desire is a cognitive function coupled to a powerful feeling state, and without the energetic aspect it is hollow and redundant. And it will function to create little of any real or personal significance. And this is, once again, a whole new shift for many people, a whole new orientation, and may potentially imply anything we saw in the first half of this section. We're starting to see some of the possible reasons people may be having trouble defining what they want.

We can now see more clearly the value of what we outlined in the first half. In returning to our own inner source and root, we recover the power and raw material which can now be forged into a creative engine. We regain the essential core-energetic threads which make up and define true desire.

This 'feeling depth', however, is still only half of what it takes to define what we truly want. If this inner connection, submission and flow is to become real creating power we must learn to apply what we gain there in ways which are both focused and integrated. What this means, and why it's so important I'll now seek to outline.

The Destination: Positive, Integrated, Active.

When a man does not know what harbour he is making for, no wind is the right wind.

- Seneca

The Negative Orientation

To feel openly and embrace our true inner nature is a giant leap toward realising the life we desire, it gives us the power and the drive to make things happen. This primary connection is what gives us

the essential material. But it is just as important what we do with what we find.

The issue here is a simple one relating to where you source your motivation in life. You can, in truth, only be motivated by two things: avoidance of negativity, or attraction to positivity. And the point here is that when one of these becomes your predominant habit in life, becoming your general orientation in relation to change, each will produce very distinct and very different results. And what's important, in relation to what we've just covered, is that increasing feeling access and turning up the volume so to speak, will increase the power and intensity of both of these orientations. So none of what we have looked at thus far will fix or address what we are about to cover.

A positive orientation in life is clearly better than a negative one. Simply because there are a million and one things in life that we don't want, and that by moving away from those we are not necessarily moving toward what we do want. If we understand that emotion is energetic tension designed to produce relational action and change, and we apply a positive orientation, then we can see how desire might be better than aversion as a focus around which to define your life. Ideally then, in terms of the relationship of core to frontal as discussed above, we see the interests of the system being naturally represented in the formation of desire.

We all display both of these orientations to some degree, but this one is very dominant at present for reasons we will come to see.

The essence of the negative orientation lies in using the presence of negative factors in life to motivate us. In focusing heavily on what we DON'T want, and on resisting or avoiding that. It is to be focused on avoiding tension and unpleasantness at any

cost; on taking the path of least resistance; on unconditionally going with the flow of life.

In terms we have already discussed, this orientation relies primarily on the negative energies of the core for its support, and on negative cathexis for its energy. And it is a very powerful approach, very useful when applied in balance, but when it becomes predominant as an approach to life in the long run is really not very satisfactory. Why? The obvious and most significant factor, if you look at it, is that such an orientation actually relies on negativity to keep it moving.

That, as a way of getting to where you want to be, it has one fatal flaw: it runs out of steam just out of the immediate range of the negativity it is escaping from, and just hovers there, inert.

The point of which is this: To move away from what you don't want is not necessarily to move toward what you do. They are NOT the same thing.

This is not to be taken lightly. This simple statement can change your life. Think about it, if you could define for yourself what you truly desire in life, then everything else would, by definition, be an aspect of what you don't want in life. I mean, everything!

Thus, embodying the negative orientation, you could quite easily shift endlessly from one negative state to another, without ever even approaching what you really desire in life.

Anyway, all this seems to be where many people find themselves. Hovering just on the fringes of all sorts of things they don't want, but never quite making it to where they really want to be. Hallmarks of the negative orientation! And, because of the very nature of change, to be so inclined is to let your life be defined by the whim of random chance in an ever changing universe.

‘But if I can just get rid of all the negative things in my life, surely I’ll be happy?’ No! Good in theory, not so good in practice. Do you have forever? Because that’s how long it would take. Everything outside of what you want is what you don’t want, is thus negatively charged. Everything! So although your unique positivity is finite and definable, the negativity it implies is, unfortunately - at least in this sense - without limits. It is endless. And to seek to achieve your ‘unique positivity’ by focussing on eliminating random negativity is a bit like throwing a handful of grain on the ground in the hope that it will, just by chance, spell out your name in scrolly Florentine script. Just not likely.

So here we see another point of interest, and another potential shift in orientation to be made. To move away from the negative, by becoming more positively oriented in life.

As an aside, this issue applies equally to our inner world as it does to the outer realm. And we see it being displayed very often in relation to what we saw in the first half of this section, especially in relation to the resolution of ‘historical baggage’.

If you were focussed only on removing negativity, then the process would be endless. But in terms of the positive orientation, something would only be negative if it directly obstructed the creation of the positive in life. You would only have to address the past if it was directly affecting the present. If it’s not, then why bother? Do you really think you are going to dig up and heal every hurt you ever suffered? And do you think you are really going to enjoy doing that? Is that really what you want to do with your life? Get real!

Thus, in the inner realm also, due to the cultural prevalence of the negative orientation, we see ‘therapy junkies’ and ‘growthers’, obsessed with

ridding themselves of every trace of historical bondage, but remaining firmly bound by the very efforts they are using to seek freedom.

I sometimes see this situation, that of being trapped from within by the kind of things we saw in the first half, as being like a bird in a cage. Our freedom has certainly been restricted, and we can't get to where we want to be in life because of it. But, and here is my point, how many bars do you need to remove before you can fly to freedom?

If you do not have 'blue skies' in mind in this whole process, you may just miss the whole point. And if you're not flapp'n your wings all the while, just think'n about it, you may not be able to fly at all when the time comes. You could, after spending years deconstructing your entire cage, end up still sitting stiff and rigid on your perch. A therapy addict!

Always look beyond your situation and history to the future you desire. A positively oriented approach is the answer once again, signified in the creation of an integrated vision of what you truly desire in life, and a demonstrated commitment to that being achieved. This positivity is precisely what will inevitably confront you with all your true obstacles, and only your true obstacles.

As an aside, the question- "What do I not want?" can also generate a vision capable of generating tension, [as can any question which appeals to the emotive core for an answer] but it is the same principle in reverse, and although it may appear very similar, actually has very different consequences. This creates a vision of the ultimate object of disdain, and emotively loads that with negative cathexis, which makes the positive polarity of this active negative vision, anything but that. Complete positive disintegration. Almost total diffusion of clear direction in life. This is the

negative orientation in heat. So although knowing what you don't want is valuable, relying on it in favour of a positive approach in life, is not.

What, then, about this positive orientation? What defines such?

It is probably pretty clear already that the opposite to the negative orientation is to be 'driven' in life by an attraction toward what you DO want, rather than just blindly repelled by what you DON'T. And here we see where it is that people get stuck. As we indicated earlier, many people simply have no idea what they really want. Leaving the negative orientation the only thing left to them. But such is what it takes, if you want to squarely pull away from the negative in life: a clear and active vision of what you are seeking in life.

And why is this so hard? Well, we've so far seen some of the things which could present potential obstacles to the formation of actively functioning desire, so I'll take those for read and move on to the few things we've not yet addressed.

Scattered vs Integrated

Another potential issue afflicting the creation of what we desire is that of inherent conflicts in our desires themselves.

The natural result of the negative orientation as we have just seen it, is that we are accustomed to our motive energies being somewhat scattered and random. Just an endless stream of negativities shunting us along. Which is further compounded by the presence of so called 'desires' which have no actual foundation in core energetic terms, and thus have no inherent integrity. Which are not real desires. But with the shift to a more positive and feeling approach, we see another potential arising.

That of organising our diverse desires into a single more cohesive structure. This, as we saw, is something not possible in the negative orientation, and thus not something many people are accustomed to doing. In fact it is not generally modelled well at all in our culture. This whole process is pretty well atrophied by the prevalence of the 'negative orientation' just outlined.

So, upon shifting to a positive focus, and correctly using positive cathexis to guide us, the immediate tendency is to simply say- 'right, GO!' And like holding a dozen sled dogs, each by its own separate leash, this can be an interesting thing to watch.

Therefore the next process I am indicating here is one in which we can make sure that all of our energies are basically heading in the same direction, that they can at least all work together for the same basic end. And what this necessarily involves is the formation of all your scattered desires into a larger unified desire, what I will call your '**vision**'.

This is something many people find difficult, or don't know how to do. The important thing to understand is that if your desires are generally not woven together in such a way, and are thus scattered or contain practical inconsistencies, you will always have trouble. Instead of tackling sometimes difficult terrain, your inner 'sled dogs' will spend a lot of energy just pulling against each other.

It is commonly presumed that to be pro-active in life you must be able to sublimate what you feel in favour of some value or ethic or dictum.⁵ But this is, in my opinion, often very misunderstood and misapplied. It should not be inferred that we should sublimate our desires in life in favour of some imposed value structure (as we have already

⁵ See 'The seven habits...' -Stephen Covey.

discussed re false persona), but that our lesser desires can be subsumed within the formation of a greater vision. Thus they are sublimated, but not denied or negated. They are integrated. It is not the sublimation of desire which makes people great creators, it is the sacrifice of lesser desire, for greater and higher desire. For a vision. Being able to save money is an example of this principle. Sacrificing lots of small spends, for one big one.

Of course, in the actual process of creation of what you desire, sacrifices will sometimes need to be made. But once again, that is not the point. More sacrifice does not necessarily mean more creation. Austerity is sometimes an unfortunate byproduct of being creative in this sense, but it is not an intrinsic part of the creative life. But because such is an overt presence in many creative lives, onlookers often confuse the two. Thus self sacrifice has become a perceived form of creative virtue, when in fact it is contrary to true healthy functioning, and is ultimately just one of those natural and unfortunate things that can emerge along the way to slow you down.

So this process is about harnessing all your energies together into a single integrated team, and involves defining a destination which appeals to all the elements involved, all the “dogs”. United we stand, divided we fall.

Making this unifying potential available is one of the most powerful consequences of the shift to the ‘positive orientation’ in life. This is major creating potential, compared to anything the negative orientation can muster. It represents a simultaneous elimination of conflict, and focus of power. [And we will see as this work progresses that we may already actively possess all the power we need to get to where we want to be, but that a lot of it is presently turned against itself, just spinning its wheels and getting nowhere. Like driving with

your handbrake on. Conflicting instructions.]

So this integrating process can be the liberation of some serious energy. But what it demands is a discipline, as I said, that many are not accustomed to and will thus have to learn – That of taking scattered desires, and forging them into an **integrated vision**.

What we see here, then, is that to be desire-focused is better than aversion-focused. And that to be vision-focused is better than being desire-focused.

Aside from whatever you may have learned from all the mistakes you have made in life thus far, just imagine taking all the ‘wrong’ or ‘dead end’ paths you have ever travelled, and all the energy you invested in them, and lay them down end to end in the direction of what you truly desire. Where would you be right now? Imagine if you’d been able to figure out back then what it was that you truly wanted in life now. Think about it. Now project yourself forward twenty years, look back and ask the same thing.....!

What all this means is taking a deeper approach to what we desire, and stripping away some of the surface features. We can see how our scattered active desires might be most effective when integrated into a larger vision, rather than dispersed like sled dogs all pulling in different directions. But it is sometimes difficult to have everything we might want at an outer level of life, simply because many things are just not possible. There are limitations and conflicts in life. But we should never confuse this fact with not being able to have what we want ultimately, at a core level. We must differentiate these two levels, and come to see that the core level does actually make sense, and that whilst fulfilling such might be complex or sophisticated, a situation can be found to fulfil it. It is simply that we must find a way to translate our

core desires into a single outward vision, one which does not conflict with itself, but still fulfils core desires. Desire must be formulated into a larger integrated 'vision', and presumably some resulting plan of action.

What we see here, if we look back over everything we have covered and how it all relates, is that to have an integrated vision of what you truly desire in life both demands and signifies the resolution of every level of dysfunction we have so far covered. Including everything in the first half of this section. It is, quite literally, a real definition of optimum systemic functioning. The formation of this vision, because it integrates all systemic desire, can be defined as the ideal functioning of our system, what those working on the 'inner' front are striving to emancipate. Dysfunction in any of the levels we have addressed in this section can act to prevent its formation.

Therefore, if everything we've covered here in terms of obstacles and dysfunction represents aspects of the scattered negativity we don't want in ourselves, then an integrated vision is the singular positivity which contrasts it.

In terms of personal growth and self development etc, what we see here is the emergence of an integrated axiom - the formation of an 'emotionally anchored and integrated vision of what you truly desire in life' is not just an optional outcome, it is the very definition of progress or success. It is the very top block in the pyramid of growth, and its presence in a person's life signifies the healthy presence of all those below it. This is very important to realise, that if this is not present, then you are not there yet.

So there we have it, surely that's worth knowing. And surely we've now covered everything? Nope! There is one other thing worth recognizing before

we get into the 'how' of all this.

Active vs Passive

Another thing which could easily contribute to this fundamental shift from negative to positive not being made, and the avoidance of desires becoming integrated into an aligned singularity, is that all of such inevitably involves a shift to an active approach to life, a very deliberate and self motivated orientation.

The negative orientation is essentially very passive, it just waits for the next negativity to come along before anything happens. People get accustomed to this, they just go wherever the wind blows them. Like being shunted around like an inert billiard ball, from one potentially negative circumstance to the next.

So the positive shift does, quite literally, imply the 'deliberate generation of inner tension' as the primary source of motive energy. And true desire is definitely a tension, the only difference being the positive focus on a particular outcome. So it is certainly not a passive approach to how things turn out. It is not very Taoist, not very surrendered, definitely not resigned. It is active in the most fundamental sense, it is to take direct responsibility for outcomes. It means to stand up for what you want, to point a stick in the ground and say 'Here! Here, I make my stand.'. Turangawaewae. It is the way of the warrior⁶.

I know of no more encouraging fact than the unquestionable ability of man to elevate his life by a conscious endeavor.

⁶ See 'The Warriors Way' - Robert de Ropp.

- Henry David Thoreau

People are always blaming their circumstances for what they are. I don't believe in circumstances. The people who get on in this world are the people who get up and look for the circumstances they want. And, if they can't find them, make them.

- George Bernard Shaw

So what the positive orientation demands, among other things, is the assumption of very real levels of tacit responsibility for your life. It means to take hold of the reins, and make things happen. It is the final end to victimhood. And some people won't like that. It is the end of being bound or defined by history or circumstance. 'But I'm like this because of what happened to me when I was young!'. That explains your history. But in light of the passive orientation, you are actually still the way you are because you are choosing to be. So this means the shift from being a 'sheep', to being a 'lion'. Unlike sheep, lions are not passively swept along by the masses, and do not need any well trodden path. They make their own path. They just go wherever they want to go.

So needless to say, couch potatoes need not apply. The fundamental battle-cry of the positive orientation = I alone am responsible for the state of my life.

Therefore, if this is where an integrated vision leads to, it is easy to see why some may avoid it, albeit unconsciously. Too much like hard work. But, like it or not, if you want to become the predominant creative force in your own life, this is what it takes. And really, its a lot easier in the long

run. The positive orientation may involve deliberate tension, but it alone leads to a tension free state. The negative orientation, in contrast, may be passive, but it sure ain't easy. It stays tense almost perpetually.

A positive orientation, then, demands a more pro-active approach to life, in contrast to simply waiting around for something to shunt you along. Desire is something we produce and uphold ourselves in order to disturb ourselves, and produce action toward a more desirable state.

As a natural extension of this view, there is a whole movement based around this type of approach⁷, essentially embodying the belief that we each have encoded within us the seeds of our unique 'path' or 'calling' in life. And that such is only felt and called to the fore when, and only when, we become prepared to **feel** and **follow** our truest and **deepest passion** in life. It is a view that this individual potential lies in each of us, sleeping as it were, until awakened by our eventual readiness to submit to it. To feel it.

This inner potential has been given many names: Daemon, entelechy, calling, etc. But they all say similar things. These approaches generally tend toward a 'spiritual' orientation, and do not base their convictions on a view of desire as I have outlined above, but neither have they been presented with such. Anyway, the essential conviction seems compatible, and their views are generally based on observation and experience. Within each of us, they say, lies a unique potential, just as within an Acorn lies an Oak. You can't see it, but it's there. Waiting. And here is the condition I suppose, the catch. For the Acorn to become the

⁷ See 'The Souls Code' or other books by James Hillman. Dr Jean Houston deals with 'entelechy', as did her mentor Teilhard de Chardin. Wilber also does a brief account of 'Daemon' in 'Grace and Grit'.

Oak, its present form must be sacrificed. It cannot have its cake and eat it too. It must return to the transformative earth, and submit to its own deeper calling. Just so with the caterpillar. To become the butterfly, it must leave all it knows and enter a process of transition. It must submit and relinquish.

This is basically the same with us. We all have a 'butterfly' within, or an 'Oak', but we are generally very afraid of it, of what we may truly desire if we really felt it, and where it may take us. Which is what we saw in the first half of this section, much of what we tend to disassociate from in our core could actually be defined as the foundations of powerful desires, but ones which, because of their scope and valence, scare us. And they scare us precisely because it is only their forces which allow you to operate at the edge of your potential, they are the only thing able to offer the energy. Your true passion contains its own creating energy, this is its defining feature. There are no substitutes

All of which is perhaps why we often don't feel as fully as we could. And thus, many of us compromise, and remain acorns and caterpillars. Always in the waiting room of life.

What we see in all of this is that a primary or summary symptom of having lost touch with your own core is that you don't know what you want. And if you don't know what you want, at least in some essential sense, you really don't know who you are. And what you really want, just like who you really are, does not just go away if you ignore it. It has its own energy, and if you do not embrace it openly, it will be this same energy that eats you away from the inside. If ignored, your daemon can become your Demon, and haunt your life. It will visit you at night, and suck the very marrow from your bones.

Death is not the greatest loss in life. The greatest loss is what dies inside us while we live.

– Norman Cousins

Let's stop for a moment –

This is probably beginning to seem like an endless procession of dysfunction, one thing leading to another, deeper and deeper. 'It's all too much' I hear you say. 'How can you possibly fix all that?' But really, I'm not indicating that all these aspects of functioning need to be addressed individually in order for everything to be straightened out here. At this stage I'm just seeking to illustrate the extent and depth of the problem, and how it directly affects people's lives. Like all living organisms, all aspects of functioning in our system exist in a kind of 'symbiotic union', everything affecting everything else, at least in some way. So, in which case, it is just possible that nothing we have addressed thus far is actually the cause of any of this, that they are all just symptoms of something deeper. And that if that deeper thing can be addressed, it may all just evaporate! Sounds good...?

And before we continue here, I should also say that there is a reason I am going into this so fully, and leaving no stones unturned, which is not only because all this has practical value, but because of how completely it integrates with what we found in the first half of this section, and how much it directly validates the basic thrust of all that. What we see emerging here is nothing short of the ideal functioning of this system, fully defined. But I am getting ahead of myself here, so back to the story...

If you are not interested in the practical diversion we are about to take at this point, I suggest you jump down to 'Making It Happen' below.

What Do I Really Want?

What does it look like, then, when you put all this together? It is a 'whole life' process, it's huge and very personal, and can take many forms. Answering this question is a mythic quest. And I'll do what I can to touch on a few highlights here, just in case you are interested.

It's actually very simple, but the results are directly commensurate with how profoundly it is applied. It is essentially a process of inquiry, coupled with a process of invention. So I'll go through it briefly, and then explain how it works, at least I myself understand it.

It seems to me to have three basic components or stages –

- a. feeling enquiry
- b. experience
- c. novel thinking

The first stage or wave is to pick up the essential core/energetic threads which define true desire. And you do this with this deceptively simple question: **what do I want to feel?**

This one will surprise you. Stay with it some time, feel into it, let this question echo through your being whenever you can. If you could be given, right now, everything you ever wanted, what would it feel like? Seek out your passion. Forget concerns about reality or possibilities at this stage, just play with feeling potentials. Find your bliss, your peace, your passion, your truest

fuzzywuzzyallaroundeyellowfeeling, or whatever you might call your highest feeling potential. See if you can find and anchor in your being the feeling state you truly desire, and make time to explore it. And there may be several or many, explore them all. Depth is better than duration in this process. A single moment of true profundity is infinitely better than a lifetime of mediocre inquiry, because this is the process which establishes the fundamental orientation necessary in catalysing true and active desire. And it is very, very important. **FEEL.**

The next stage is to begin to notice what, out of all the things you do, or have done, give you these feelings. Thus, the inquiry: what gives me these feelings? Collect the associations like little snapshots in your mind. Don't be surprised if they are hard to keep in your awareness, this is just your unconscious trying to stop you doing this. It can be somewhat disturbing to your equilibrium to do this, it stirs up deep energies. Stay with it, and keep searching. Explore your past for these things, explore the present for these things, imagine the kind of things which may fit this criterion. All the while keeping the feeling states from the first stage active in your being as guides.

The third stage is to begin to gestate and percolate and expand the inquiry you have thus begun in the first two stages. You can then begin to ask the question: **what do I really want?** But do so in a specific context. Take all the limitations off. Forget reality. Let yourself go just for moments. This functions to allow your blinkers to fall away for a brief time, and opens the possibility for leaps of insight to occur. Just think, even for a moment - 'what if I could have anything....!' Dare to say it. Just say it!!!!

You don't need to stay long at this, if the prior two have been done with resolve. Sneak up on yourself

with it, once again depth is better than duration. It's all in how you ask the question, and in the preparation stages. And you may surprise yourself, the answer may be contained in the very first impression, the first time you **really** ask it and dare to take the limits off. Though, because - through suspending realism - you are not appealing to the conscious rational mind at this stage, it may not be in a form you immediately recognize. Let yourself free-associate. Once it does gradually or suddenly emerge, the form can often be mythic or archaic in nature, but will, if you look closely, contain very important information from your core itself. Look for the underlying patterns which appear, and ignore the surface structure. Once you have the core concept, you are home and hosed. The chassis of a vision is there, and the rest is detail. You will have the core template of what can then become your own unique 'blueprint' for life.

Really, that's it. What I've just outlined there is a definition - one of many - of how you could approach this question, and just that, as I defined it, will produce astounding results if applied without reservation, because it displays the essential characteristics which must be present if you are to generate true creative power. It is correctly oriented around positive feeling as its primary axiom. It then seeks to set the formative foundations for a creative emergence by associating those feeling states with actual things or relational exchanges. And it then simply drops the whole thing on the system spontaneously as an open inquiry, prompting a creative leap.

There is obviously a lot more to this simple process than meets the eye. So don't knock it 'till you've tried it! It can move some big energies around.

But for the more intrepid, you probably want to know how it all works so that you can 'turbo charge'

it, and take it to the limits. After all, you may be very serious about this, which is good, because sometimes that's what it takes. So I'll break it down.

The essential process here is to connect with and inwardly anchor the primary positive feeling states. Which is simply a reflection of the native and healthy orientation between surface and core. The orientation which every aspect of dysfunction we covered in the first half of this section is a negation. **'What do I really want to feel?'** is, for reasons we will later see, simply a very healthy question to ask yourself. It is precisely this primary feeling orientation which gets lost or obscured over time by repression and oppression. So this orientation - and the feeling states it implicates - are the very foundations of all the rest. They set the essential tone of the whole inquiry. If you don't know what you want to feel, then the rest of the inquiry is effectively blind, and will have no compass bearings to follow. So what this process does is establish the most primary integrity, the most basic foundations, and for this reason don't be surprised if it is frustratingly slippery and difficult to pursue. This basic element of your functional integrity has been eroded over time for very good reasons, and you will be thwarting all that by turning energy back in that direction. The return of the positive effects of this may begin to purge or push out the negative dysfunction from the system, as we saw in the first half. Your unconscious may resist. It can give you nightmares! So this is very simple, no big deal, but it is far more profound than it may appear.

'What do I really want to feel?'

You must feel in order to answer this question, and that can turn the heat up a bit on whatever's happening within, but doing so establishes and strengthens the 'tap roots' which give the whole

creative tree its 'life blood'. And success in all that follows depends entirely on the foundations and connections established here. And this process is not 'therapeutic'. Not some temporary quick fix. It is, or will become, permanent. It is itself the essential or primary shift necessary for stable adaptation to the positive orientation in life.

So next, the next stage so to speak, with a 'taste' for the positive established, is to collect and extract from known relational exchanges the underlying feeling states concerned. And we are only interested in the positive ones in this process, but you can do this with any, positive, negative or neutral.

What does that mean? Everything you do, or know, or have done, or have had, or have thought you were going to do, has - associated with it - an inherent emotive charge. On the strength of pure experience, your core ascribes this charge to things on the basis of certain levels of relational exchange we are generally not consciously aware of. So this charge or 'feeling' regarding something represents some underlying transaction significant to the core. As we progress later in sections two and three, we'll be looking to the next level again, looking at the underlying functional element beneath these emotive charges, and we'll be able to see what they're all about. But for now, because we are seeking to define an actual relational and objective state which would accurately represent the core feeling state we desire, the point is to simply begin to cluster and gather all the things we know on that surface level which approximate that positive feeling. Thus we are somewhat reliant on our history here. If we have never experienced anything which even approximates what we truly desire, if we have lived a very sheltered and narrow life, this bit can be somewhat hobbled. You'll have less to work with. But that's actually ok in the end anyway, your creative process in the next stage will

be less distracted and corrupted by history or circumstance, but will, unfortunately, have further to jump.

But at this stage, the more experience you have of doing things you really like, of following your truest passion in life, the easier this aspect will be. In fact both of the stages we have just covered will be easier.

So what we are doing here is collecting all the things we most like or want in life, which implies that they each contain a strong positive charge. Now, and here is the point, the objective is to subtly begin to see if you can separate the **core** element from the **surface** one. Ask yourself - 'What is it about the particular thing or relational exchange which the core likes, and is attached to?' What is the underlying transaction? We are beginning to learn about our own emotive core here, and how it works. And this is the key, for if happiness is truly a matter of desire/satisfaction then it is the core which holds the purse strings.

This whole process, then, is one of gathering positively charged surface structures, and gradually examining them for clues as to the underlying elements the core is relating to. And what we end up with, over time, is a cluster of things which all represent elements of what we ultimately desire, at least in core terms, and hopefully some idea of why we like them.

Remember, the core is fulfilling a function, and its movements should make sense, if you can figure them out.

Here are some random examples of core and surface differentiation -

You say you like **hamburgers**?

Your core probably likes **food**.

You say you love to **hang glide**?

Your core probably likes **freedom**.

You're into having lots of **money**?

Your core probably likes creative **power**.

You say you love **Jamaica**?

Your core may love a **tropical climate**.

You say you like that **girl** or **guy** over there!

Your core probably likes **touch, intimacy, and sex.....**

So what you start off with is hamburgers, and hang gliding, and money and Jamaica and Jo Smith over there. And the answer is obviously not some creative combination of the above. But hopefully what you end up with, as the foundations for the next step, is food, and freedom, and power, and a tropical climate, and touch, and intimacy, and sex.....all the positive **core elements**, without the **surface structures**.

This gives you a lot more flexibility. A kind of 'outcomes list' for whatever your ultimate creation will contain or fulfil, at least in core terms. That is the objective of this stage. Bloody hell, all these stages and sections and steps...! Really it's all just one process, I'm just taking it all apart in order to make it very clear.

Now, in this stage, to make things easier, your life can actually be broken into distinct facets or sections. Certain primary aspects of life can be

addressed separately, such as health, job and relationships etc. And because they are both areas of particular interest for most, the latter two - perhaps the two most significant creative choices you will ever make - will be given a special treatment in later works (see 2EQ-104). But ultimately they must all fit seamlessly together, so regardless, the results must eventually be recompiled for the next and final stage.

The third stage is to put all this together, to formulate it as an active question in the mind. It is to simply imagine, or literally invent, a surface structure that simultaneously contains or fulfils all these core elements: everything on your outcomes list, all at once. Scattered core desires define a question, it's your job to answer it. And once you realise what this process of cognitive integration takes, it is very tempting - due to the very searching nature of the first two stages - to seek to skip the feeling bits and jump straight to this bit. But that would be to miss the whole point. Without the foundations, you can't build the castle. The answer, as always, is in asking the question correctly.

The process I'm indicating here is not well understood and is a very important aspect of producing a vision with integrity and 'custom made' novelty. So if you want to know more about it and what it involves, I'm going to put a section on this process of truly inventive or original thought in appendix A at the end: a process which demands great tension if you want great results, as you will see there. But also certainly worth everything it demands, if what you are looking for are answers which truly reflect your own unique passion or calling, and therefore answers you won't ever find in a book - unless of course you write that book yourself.

So all this is obviously not what people are used to,

and seems a bit long-winded. But it all becomes seamless and naturally established over time, so that you don't even have to think about it. We can see, however, how as a potential definition of healthy inner functioning it will inevitably strike some resistance initially. It can rock the boat big-time. This is to be expected, so don't worry about it.

- So the first stage is setting the orientation, and is purely emotive. Complete submission to core. Not what we are used to doing.
- The last stage is literally pure creation, active invention, original thought, pulling something out of the ether. Also something we are not generally accustomed to.
- And the middle stage is a natural bridge between them, the vital connection which provides the essential foundations for the third.

Without any one of these three the other two will not function to achieve the intended result: the formulation of the foundational elements of an integrated personal vision of what you truly desire in life. And together, they represent a profoundly searching process, one which utilises every span and depth of our inner potential in its functioning. Which seems appropriate given what we saw about the functional significance of its intended outcome, an integrated vision.

Actually, if you examine what you already presume about life and happiness you will probably see that this is what you are already doing, if only by degrees. You are already seeking a life which reflects your own true being, even if you don't know it. But now we can see where it might be getting stuck. We must all take off the judgments of cultural expectation and conditioning and simply be honest! And this demands invention, precisely

because you are unique. It requires **submission**, **feeling**, and **invention**. But it also means discovering your unique contribution, and living fully.

What we have seen here, then, is what happens inside just the first of three main stages of creation. This is just the formative part, the process of defining the destination for your journey. And it is a process that itself comprises three basic elements, and that we have covered all but the final process - true novel thinking.

So this is that it looks like now:

1. Creative-formative [defining the destination]
 - a. Feeling enquiry
 - b. Experience
 - c. Novel thinking
2. Planning-organisational [defining the path]
3. Implementation [walking the path]

Truly generative or novel thinking, which is the bit we have not covered here, is something we are often not taught. It is the essential capacity to think creatively, to generate new ideas, novel emergences, to cut truly new ground and open doors nobody has opened before. Even in isolation this is a function which represents one of the highest human potentials, in that it utilises all of our creative resources in a single process. It is perhaps the single most demanding and significant capacity we have, if it is used well. And what we see is that it is often used in isolation to solve great theoretical or abstract problems. But what I would like to point to here is its native function, its right and true function. Its true significance cannot be seen in isolation. It is part of something much greater, and has a vital role to perform. It is always ungrounded and lacking purpose on its own. Its true significance is as an essential part of an

overall pattern or creation which represents the optimum functioning of the system. True creativity is the flower of the human tree.

This final process - novel thinking - could be defined as the **essential creative element** of the **essential creative stage** of the **entire creative process**. Which means it is supremely important, if ever you wish to be powerfully creative. It is a capacity which catalyses other functions, representing the opportunity to produce a final unity of all optimum functioning of the human system. Novel thinking, the capacity to originate truly new ideas, is true intelligence.⁸

In the context we are discussing here, the question - "What do I truly want/desire?" is actually the only question capable of finally generating an integrated 'tension generating vision'. And this is because of the way it forces us to follow the process above in order to answer such a question, as opposed to other questions. And this is perhaps why people don't generally ask it with any great gusto. In the very process of asking, this question must appeal directly to the emotive core in order to find or create an answer, and is only finally satisfied when the resulting answer fulfils the emotive requirements of the core. At which time, and because of the process itself, the emotive core naturally **bonds** with that vision, and emotively 'loads' it with felt meaning. It is, after all, not the mental component which generates the creative tension, it is the emotive meaning associated with this vision, the cathexis it holds, either positive or negative, and the proximity of the desired vision to the perceived truth. The thing which defines a true vision is not its content, but its emotional charge. Not so much what you want, it is defined much more by how much you want it, and how authentic that emotional connection is.

⁸See appendix A. for an outline of what I am calling Novel Thinking.

Making it happen.

The Final End of the Bridge

If you have built castles in the air, your work need not be lost; that is where they should be. Now put the foundations under them.

- Henry David Thoreau

A vision without a task is but a dream, a task without a vision is drudgery, a vision and a task is the hope of the world.

- From a church in England, 1730

So then, vision in hand, the defining half is done. What now? What can we say about the getting bit that's going to be of any use? The process of actually effecting the changes your vision prescribes? Well, as I hope has become obvious, real and authentic desire has its own creating energy, that it actually is our creative faculty. It is the driving force of creation in our lives, and that it generally figures out ways of achievement all by itself. We don't drive desire actually, it drives us! In particular, it will drive us bloody crazy if we don't find ways to change things toward better alignment with it. But fortunately it also provides all the energy and motivation we need in doing so.

So the methods or modes of influence we employ may be as many and varied as the situations we each find ourselves in. Some say mind power is the way! That you become what you meditate on. Some say believe it, and it will happen! I myself lean toward more old fashioned concepts of forward

thinking, good planning, and committed action. After all, we are looking at real change here, not just a shift in perception. But, choose your poison I guess. Whatever you think is going to get you there.

The important thing is to understand what we have already covered. You don't need to make it happen. Because of the way you did this, if you did it right, it all happens by itself from this point forward. But a couple of things do perhaps need to be said about the process of actually realising the creation of vision in life, which, to my mind, seem pretty important. Things which, if they are not understood, can slow you down considerably.

The first is that desire - especially an integrated vision - is a tension. How many times am I going to say that? But it's important. It is supposed to create inner leverage. That is its purpose. And it does this to the exact degree that what you have and what you want differ. So, and this is my point, it is only going to be effective in driving positive change in your life, you are prepared to actually feel it. And to really do that in the most creative sense you have to be able to accept and have no delusions about your current state or circumstance.

If you can't see things for what they are, then a vision of how you would like them to be will be of no use to you. If you can't acknowledge that you are in the shit, how can you ever hope to get out of it? Desire is a tension, it stretches like a rubber band between where you are, and where you want to be. So the first step to getting where you want to be, is accepting where you actually are!

You must be fiercely open eyed. It is reality which anchors your vision, and the divergence between your truth and your vision which produces the creative tension. Thus, many people upon actualising a vision of what they want often lose sight of what they have, accidentally on purpose.

Thus avoiding the very thing capable of affecting the change they desire: tension. So if you want to be truly creative in this sense, you must befriend reality, as well as your vision, and learn to harness and direct the resulting energy in constructive ways. This is the creative process. 'Luck' or 'divine inspiration' has nothing to do with your capacity to create. It is a combination of passion and simple hard labour. A real discipline, it is something you must learn, and practice.

The second thing is the tacit relationship between fear and commitment. I still love this quote, even though it is well used -

Until one is committed there is hesitancy, the chance to draw back, always ineffectiveness. Concerning all acts of initiative (and creation), there is one elementary truth, the ignorance of which kills countless ideas and splendid plans: that the moment one definitely commits oneself, then Providence moves too. All sorts of things occur to help one that would never otherwise have occurred. A whole stream of events issues from the decision, raising in one's favour all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would come his way. I have learned a deep respect of one of Goethe's couplets:

Whatever you can do, or dream you can, begin it. Boldness has genius, power, and magic in it.

- W.H.Murray

Our doubts are traitors and make us lose the good we oft might win, by fearing to attempt.

-Shakespeare

Do or do not. There is no try.

- Yoda

True creativity is not the easy path, especially if it's been absent. It often demands that we sail hard into the prevailing wind. But in the end, due to our efforts, we are the ones who eventually make it to the calm of the harbour.

You've simply got to have the courage to stand behind your passion, and, if it demands it, to leap out into the void. To be prepared to commit yourself without reservation to the outcome you have defined. Sometimes you've just got to jump. And in the process, to step beyond a life defined by fear. Some people see doubt as being detrimental to commitment, but if you examine this a little closer you see that doubt is itself energy that could otherwise be helping to push a vision through to creation. There is a defining moment in any creation when you need to cross a threshold, a point of no return. Until then your job is to doubt, to get all your doubt out of the way. Like jumping a crevasse you need to be careful. But once you decide, you also need to be clear. You are either doing it, or you are not, and even the slightest hesitancy can produce very serious results. I see this a lot. I see the results of hesitancy beyond the commitment threshold, and I see the damage it can cause.

There is a time for deliberation, and that time is crucial as we have just seen, but there is also a time for courage. And they must be clearly separated, because a confusion of the two is a disaster. Beyond the point where this decision has been made, it must be recognised that doubt is not just a distracting nuisance, it is itself a lack of commitment. They are the very same thing, defined in different terms, the two sides of the very same coin. And the emergence of doubt beyond the point of commitment is a true creative sin.

So when do you know? How do you decide when to cross that threshold and fully commit? You don't. You simply reach a point where you take all remaining doubt and forge it into singular commitment. And when do you do this? The peak of that tide is always the same – it is simply and always the present moment. NOW. Now is the only time you can act, and is thus your only point of true power. The past must be accepted as immutable. The rest of your life begins now. If you are not prepared to turn your vision into action at this moment, then it is ultimately a lost cause. You are just a dreamer.

Why Not???

What we are discussing here is our power to create, to determine change, and there are obviously factors that come into play here to influence how fully we embrace our own creative potential. So we should have a look at these as well. Foremost amongst which must be that powerful and integrated desire is as much a destroyer as it is a creator. It is an agent for change. True and connected desire formulated on the basis of profound emotional self-inquiry has its own creating energy. The very process of asking animates processes that are designed to influence your conscious will, not to be a servant to it. In asking the question you are awakening your own deeper self, and you cannot simply turn it off again if it becomes uncomfortable to the status quo. And here we see the main reason people cannot figure out what they want – because it conflicts too much with what they already have, and would therefore be too dangerous to connect with. Which, said another way, means that the thing most preventing you from having what you want, is what you've already got. You are calling forth your creative potential here, and to try to put it back is like trying to turn a flower back into a bud. Therefore, to get

what you really desire in life you must often be prepared to let go of what you already have. Which for many people, because they are so far removed from what they truly desire, means that the key to finding their true passion lies at least partly in their willingness to surrender to what arises, to go wherever it leads, and do what it takes. Without this willingness, such an inquiry - because of the pointless tension it would create - will always come back blank. Your own deeper system will not allow the formulation of true passion if it will simply not have the room it requires to fly. Until you first 'open the gate' the core will not 'whip the bull'.

Lets summarise then: A positive orientation is better than a negative one. An active orientation is better than a passive one. Integrated vision is better than scattered desires. But the shift to each of these involves certain demands and involves greater levels of active responsibility for the creation of what you desire in life. It is a process we are often not taught, and involves a significant degree of creative energy and self-responsibility. In other words, 'couch potatoes' need not apply.

So we can immediately see some reasons why we may shy away from fully embracing this way of being. There are, however, many processes by which we may actively support this approach. Every motivational guru has another slant. And there is no reason why we cannot take everything above into account and fully apply ourselves to this path. To submit ourselves without reservation to the formulation of our deepest desires into an active and integrated vision of life as we desire it. And to be prepared to follow that dream.

Desire is an attachment to something specific, because of the feeling states that thing represents in general. And the more positive feeling states a particular desire represents, the more attachment

associated, and the more powerful the energy behind it. Likewise with aversion. And so to feel, as we outlined in the first half, to open up to yourself and to integrate aspects of your deeper nature which had been held in transit as it were, is to recover these basic drive energies, these generators of primary cathexis, both positive and negative. It is, effectively, to turn the volume up at an energetic/emotive level. And it is, therefore, to increase your creating power. And will only happen to the degree you are capable of governing and managing such power. If it threatens to overload you, your system will simply shut it down, which is what happened in the first place, and why they were originally suspended.

As complex as this all may be in detail, it is a pretty simple process in general, and you're probably wondering why it's not applied more often? Well, the answer is in the significance of what it can produce. This simple process has huge ramifications. We've already seen how many aspects of our inner functioning an 'active vision' implicates even in its formation. And if you're truly going to apply this model fully then it's worth having a very clear understanding of such things and what it's up against, and why people don't already do it. And there are some pretty big ones in this lot, many we haven't covered. All of these are things you are going to have to address and get out of the way if you are going to make the inner 'space' for this process to really do its work and formulate an active vision. So this is what this simple process is up against.

Why don't people do this already, why aren't people very powerfully creative?

- **Low self esteem** is a big player. 'I can't have what I really want', 'I can't do it', 'I don't deserve it', etc. To feel and connect with

what you truly desire, and to equally feel you cannot - or do not deserve - to have it, is not emotionally acceptable. There are reasons for such beliefs as we will see later, and they are not as easy to simply shift or change as they may appear. In origin, to believe you do not deserve to have what you desire is a very effective way of controlling negative emotion in a situation where you aren't getting what you need. It is what allows you to accept circumstances which are actually unacceptable to your core. And because these are core beliefs relating to who you are in essence, the point here is that if you go and alter them toward a more positive state, your core - because it has great integrity - will naturally **backdate** the changes. If I'm not a worthy person, then what happened to me back then doesn't matter. But if I am, then now I'm pissed off! So moving this stuff, which is what this whole process demands, is often a very moving experience, and takes time to integrate. Old hurts come back to haunt us when we start to re-establish what they took from us in terms of self esteem. These beliefs are held in place by the pain you avoided by putting them in place, and to release them you must face that pain, feel it, and let it go.

- Another is that people are **not ready** for this kind of change, that they are waiting for 'right time', the 'green light'. If's, but's and when's! The answer to this one - which people don't want to hear - is that there is never a right time. The only time to begin your life is right now. You just do it.
- **Powerful tension** is another reason. Desire is a very deep inner tension which is designed to move us, but too much of it can be experienced as toxic, especially if you're not used to it. The tension is directly equivalent to the significance of what is desired, over

your proximity to it. Which is where the problem comes for many, that precisely because they have not done this before or been operating in a positively oriented manner, what they truly and deeply desire is often very far away from what they actually have. And thus to feel it produces massive tension in a state which, by definition, is already being experienced as negative. It produces tension overload. A real double bind. The very question "what do I really want?" is painful to ask in such a state. But I have to ask: do we avoid asking the question because of our negative state, or is our negative state the result of not asking the question? You can't get closer to it if you don't feel it, and you can't feel it until you get closer to it! Your system, unconsciously, will simply not allow the integration of a vision based on truly felt desire if you cannot carry the emotional load. And that is because this process literally anchors such, and is not easy - once actualised - to simply turn it off again. You must learn to carry and direct the inherent tension a powerful creativity in life demands, and the more you do, the more easily you will find inward access to what you truly desire. Your own system will stop shutting it away from you once it knows you are not going to collapse under its weight. So being far from what you desire in life is actually a good opportunity to practise true creative power! If you can handle feeling it at that distance, you'll be goin' off when you get closer. You'll have lots of creative potential to spare, and - amongst other things - that means money. So all I can suggest in this case, is to expand your capacity to handle and direct tension. Focus on whatever positive change you can. Anything's better than nothing. If you can't see the top of the mountain you are climbing, simply head

toward the next high point you can see, and from there look around for the next. Eventually you may find a place from where you can finally see the top. The closer you actually get to what you want, the easier it is to define. A vicious circle you might say, but I would say a positive spiral, because it's just as positive as it is negative. Once you actually get it, the same dynamic also makes it very difficult to ever lose it again.

- **Protection of the status quo** is another real biggie. People like things to be comfortable and easy, which is natural. But this whole process is the formation of an active sequence of change toward what it defines. And thus, very often, to have what you really want, you must be prepared to relinquish aspects of what you already have in the process. To move toward the life you truly desire is sometimes no Sunday picnic, especially if you're applying it to its creative limits. It is, in this sense, as destructive as it is creative. It is a **destroyer**. And holding firm to any set surface structure, although such is the reality for most people, is one of the greatest limitations this process can face in terms of producing truly incredible results. It is a fundamental corruption of the final creative process as outlined in appendix B. If you circumvent the creative/inventive process by imposing set surface features you wish to protect, then you directly prevent the kind of cognitive leaps which this process is capable of producing. The main cause of such 'contamination' is the amount of historical investment certain things represent emotionally, as well as time based issues such as contracts or commitments. Thus relationships, aspects of false personas, jobs, cultural expectations, all come under the axe if you are going to truly commit

yourself to this process. Very scary! But hey, if it doesn't end up in your vision, you didn't want it anyway! If you love something, set it free, if it comes back....it'll thank you for it! You have to have the courage to ask yourself: is what I already have, what I really want, or is it just what I have to make me feel better about not having what I really want? The reality is, for most people however, that they will not submit certain aspects of their lives to this inquiry. Which is understandable but unfortunate, because in doing so they are potentially choosing such over happiness, and in the process generating resentment. If it's what you really want, it'll come back to you on this surrendered path. And if it's not, well, it wasn't worth holding onto. So here we all face a big choice. The more you 'protect' from this process, the less power it has to fundamentally transform your life. Sometimes the only thing standing between you and the future you might enjoy, is your attachment to the past you didn't. The current prevalence of divorce could well reflect the healthy fact that people are no longer prepared to believe that they deserve to suffer what they don't want in life, or that there is some virtue in doing so.

- **Limited feeling access** is a big limitation for many also, that they simply don't feel much at all. Body,...what body? We covered this earlier. The result of years of enforced separation between surface and core. Many such barriers are physical affectations in the body, and there are many things which function to remove them. We'll be going into all that later in section four, but for now all I can suggest is to eat brown rice, exercise, get deep tissue and abdominal massage often, and learn how to really breathe again like you did when you were a baby.

- **It requires submission.** If this process is followed through, it loads an active and powerful force within our being, and it doesn't just stop or turn off. This process deeply anchors it. It literally functions to bond a core energetic function to a surface cognitive one, and in doing so anchors an emotional attachment. It's like inviting a bulldozer into your life, one with no brakes short of the realisation of what you desire. If you're not prepared to do what it takes, to submit to its dictates, then honestly, I'd suggest you don't do it. Your true path may not be easy. But you will find that it comes with its own energy. It may actually be the most difficult and challenging thing you ever do, but it will be fed by seemingly endless passion. So you've got to be prepared to hold on and go for what could be a very wild ride. You've got to do what it takes. You don't choose it, it chooses you. And it will demand things of you that you didn't know you even possessed. To get it all, you've got to give it all.
- And it is, once again, a process of very profound inward and outward **change**. From negative to positive, passive to active, scattered to integrated. And that's just inside, it's huge. Change can be perceived as very scary until you are once again accustomed to it as normal. It must inevitably disturb the rut. Habits. The easy path is always to stay where you are.
- And with everything above, we see the foundations for the biggie. **FEAR**. The king pin obstacle is that people are essentially **afraid** of their desires, and don't realise what true vision demands. And that, in these terms, a lot of what we saw in the first half of this section could well be defined as the

active repression of authentic desire. Fear. Essentially, fear of ourselves.

- And finally, though I could certainly go on, there is the process I outline in appendix B. The third ‘creative/inventive’ stage of defining a vision. We don’t generally get taught this, and it may require some fostering. And it undoubtedly requires considerable application and dedication if its potentials are to be realised, and dramatic results achieved.

So there we have it. Conjuring up an integrated vision is no mean feat. Although it all comes together in a simple process, we’re starting to see why people have trouble. This is what it’s up against. But if what they say about desire is true, then if you can define such, and make it happen, then you **will** be happy.

Summary and Conclusions

Does it work, then?

What, then, is the result of such when this approach is applied without reservation? The optimum fulfilment of desire? - Happiness! Well, that would be nice, but this is simply not the case. Certainly all this can make a huge difference for most people in their lives. The mere shift toward a positive orientation can be a revolution for many. It is movement in the right direction. But what we see here really - once all the wrinkles are ironed out in the practice of defining a life vision - is that a final synthesis almost always remains elusive.

So there we have it. The approach to happiness based on desire. At least as I've come to see it.

Do I believe all this is a valuable approach?

Yes.

Do I believe the essential process I defined here truly represents ideal or optimum healthy functioning in some essential sense?

Yes.

Do I adhere to the basic orientation all this suggests concerning the value and integrity of feelings and deeper inner states?

Yes, I do.

Is happiness, then, really just a matter of desire over satisfaction?

Yes, it is.

So does all this actually work?

No. No it doesn't.

What? What do you mean it doesn't work?!!

No, although great gains can be made, in the end - as it goes deeper - it simply doesn't work.

How can this be, what else can we possibly cover? We've ironed out all the wrinkles and it still doesn't produce an emotionally anchored and integrated vision? Why the hell not?

Because, and here is the big one, the very point of this whole section -

It would seem that the very point of integrity this whole approach presumes and relies upon is lacking full integrity. Desire itself seems to be somewhat disturbed or conflicted, which brings this whole approach and philosophy into question.

It can be seen that the process we are examining here is actually nothing more than the natural function of the frontal conscious self. It is a definition of perfect functioning. The frontal self is charged with taking impulses and influences from the emotive core and forging them into a relational program that fulfils the system's underlying interests. The conscious frontal self is merely the tip of an enormous functional iceberg, in which even the deepest desire is still only a surface level event. The frontal self can't see deeper than emotion, and is not supposed to. Which is how it should be. Except that in the event of some kind of fault, the frontal self cannot look deeper than the level of desire in order to understand or address any apparent conflict. And even if it could see deeper, it is not supposed to question influence from the core, because it would be meddling with its own foundations. The whole frontal system is designed to presume the integrity of the emotive core in the way we have fully explored here. To the degree we question, we are supposed to suffer. Which would be OK if the core could not ever suffer from conflict, but apparently - in our case - it can. And this is where we get stuck.

So for the frontal self a conflict in the formation of desire is an irresolvable dilemma. Because

integrated desire ultimately represents a summary of all systemic interests, such a conflict strikes to the very heart of life. It either signifies that desire does not represent need, that needs are themselves lacking in integrity, or that needs are somehow being misrepresented. Either way it produces relational demands which are simply impossible for the frontal self to fulfil.

Desire, the very axiom and point of fundamental integrity around which the systems functioning - and thus this entire approach - revolves, is dramatically and dynamically conflicted. Its integrity has been disturbed and effectively lost. There is actually no way of making sense of it at a surface level. It is simply not possible. It has come to represent two opposing agendas, the native and an added secondary agenda, and the resulting dynamic conflict is effectively an impasse in emotional and relational terms.

This is a very significant conflict. Remember that desire represents, summarises and reflects all emotive tensions in the system at every level. It's a biggie. The biggie.

The vision this core state would produce, if such could even be defined, would be impossible to create. Likewise, anything possible to create, could not be what this core state desires. It would inherently contain severe logical and practical inconsistencies. So all we have covered is correct, even the placement of desire at the top of the chain, but something has affected desire - the very source and signifier of systemic integrity. We have lost true north, the very thing the whole system demands and relies upon for its entire direction and integrity. ***LE ROI EST MORT!***

Its integrity has not been entirely removed however, just conflicted. But it has become

profoundly obscured by an imposed secondary presence.

As I mentioned in the introduction, this conflict has historically been presumed to be intrinsic. And in the face of this, some people have responded with the opposite approach the same view of happiness prescribes - That if happiness is a matter of desire over satisfaction, then instead of seeking satisfaction, why not simply negate desire? And here we see the foundations of the austere and ascetic approaches to human life and happiness: that you can be happy on a bed of nails.

Buddhism says that “attachment is the root of all suffering”.

Desire, as we have seen, is a very focused form of attachment.

This is the other side of that same basic view of happiness, the side we haven't studied here. Thus we see the historical rise of austere approaches to being happy and serene. Taoism, Buddhism, Jianism, renunciative Christianity-Islam-Hindu.....they all say essentially the same thing: the root of all human suffering is attachment.

The basic thrust of these passive and austere approaches, in practical terms, is that if we can just rid ourselves of every trace of attachment and desire, that we will be happy.

What do you think? Does this sound right? Are we onto a winner here? No, I don't think so. Therefore, my presumption will be this: the problem lies deeper than this; that whilst the common 'fulfilment' based approaches [outlined above] seek to integrate many dysfunctional elements of desire which are not native to us, the 'austere' approaches do the opposite and throw out the baby

with the bathwater. What ends up happening in the approach I have advocated in this section is that in submitting unconditionally to desire et al, we inevitably include and embody emotive drives which are not part of the system's native integrity, and which thus produce conflict. But in these austere approaches, what we see is just the opposite: that is seeking to root out the apparent conflict, they end up negating and removing much of the system's authentic desire, and thus much of its primary functional integrity. One view sees desire as all good, the other as all bad, when in fact a combination of the two is actually the case. Attachment and desire are a natural and integral part of healthy life. We need them. To which you might say there is a balance to be found. But to the contrary, I believe there is a differentiation to be made, and that on the basis of such, an entirely different path becomes available. That of resolving this deeper issue rather than simply forever confronting surface level symptoms of it.

So here we have the foundations of a grand historical debate as to the virtues and value of our own inner states, and in particular the value of emotion, desire and deep process functions; our general orientation in relation to our own deeper natures. The question here, once again, is whether or not to follow what you feel? In particular- is desire valuable? Can we trust our own energies to direct us in life?

And my simple assertion at this point is that what we see here is evidence of a deeper conflict within the system. Desire, as we encounter it within ourselves, is actually neither all good as some would have it, nor all bad, but a dynamic mixture of both. And that it is also not true that this conflict constitutes an inherent conflict between good and evil in man. Actually, this conflict is not intrinsic to us at all.

This conflict is, however, the real underlying reason we do not embrace desire as an absolute axiom around which to live, because to do so simply creates suffering. It just doesn't work, at least not fully and openly as it should, simply because whenever anyone fully submits themselves to fulfilling it without reservation, the practical results are usually somewhat less than satisfactory. Such seems to produce a great deal of highly charged conflict and confusion, and just doesn't go anywhere particularly worthwhile.

Over time this conflicted inner state has also given rise to 'ethics' and 'dictums' which have historically sought to define certain desires as valuable or good, and others as worthless or bad. The problem with this has always been where you draw the line. And also that, in imposing such a perspective, certain elements of real - though conflicted - desire are necessarily suppressed or denied. What do you do with the bits you don't like?

So is this the right approach? Clearly not, because it generates the basic breach indicated in the first half of this section. Even if it were possible to accurately draw the line between the two agendas and differentiate them in some way, it would still demand significant repression to enforce. This secondary agenda produces real emotive drives and desires, and they cannot simply be ignored or denied without some kind of trouble. But what becomes obvious - in gaining the understanding necessary to go beneath and distinguish the two - is that there seems to be no obvious reason why this whole secondary agenda, and all its underlying functioning, can't simply be entirely removed. And let's be clear here, what such a possibility implies is the potential resolution of **ALL** the levels and forms of systemic dysfunction we have addressed in this whole section. All of it.

So has all this been a waste of time? Certainly not, because it has to be asked: Is all this potential dysfunction the cause of people not being able to define what it is that they really want? Or is it the other way around? Is it not possible - as the vital factor in the shift we are indicating here - that everything we have discussed thus far could easily be the natural result of our incapacity to formulate an active and integrated vision? All of it? Yes. That is actually possible. Because without this vision, how can we take active responsibility for its creation? Or avoid our energies being scattered? Or not be left wallowing in a negatively oriented state? We can't. If your life is not predominantly driven by a definable positive vision, you are, by definition or default, predominantly negatively oriented, and will suffer the results of such. There is no way around this.

In fact, this is what I generally presume to be the case. When I first became aware of these creative potentials, I was examining the creative process in the wide context of 'whole life creation and maintenance', and became aware of how the processes seemed to utilise and align so many aspects of systemic functioning in a display of integration which was simply uncanny. All of which eventually led me to become aware of a possibility that would have a powerful influence on the future of my thinking in this area. Was it possible that

1. The creative processes not only represent a very high degree of functional integrity, but that...
2. 'Whole life creation and maintenance' is not only a limited systemic function, but that it is in fact the underlying purpose of the entire emotive structure? That it is not simply something the system can do, but that it is actually what the system does, full stop!

That this is what it is all actually for. And that the creative processes as I was defining them were fitting together so well not by accident, but because what I was defining was nothing more than a correct utilisation of systems which were specifically designed to do just that: create things!

So the integrated application of all the system's creative potentials towards the creation and maintenance of what you truly desire - in whole life terms - may not simply be another structural potential, but that such a process may actually represent the apex or pinnacle of systemic functioning, and that this goal therefore represents the very purpose of the structures involved.

I believe it will become clear in time that the underlying conflict we suffer from is the true reason why this seemingly very simple process is, for most people, experienced as extraordinarily searching and challenging. Its fulfilment signifies so much. This process is the ideal orientation of the persona in relation to the core, the relationship we discussed at the very beginning of this section, and that, therefore, if you can simply do this, you can forget about psychodrama, all the analysis, all the personal growth seminars. If you have a true and integrated vision of what you want in life, and are on your way to creating it, then in terms of personal growth, you are there! Because such is the positivity of which dysfunction is, by definition, an aberration or disturbance.

So remember all this, because although it remains somewhat afflicted at the moment, this is where - upon addressing this underlying conflict - we will inevitably return. Because it is just possible that the negative orientation we observe around us, and within us, is simply what remains in the absence of the one key element necessary for an active,

integrated and positively oriented life: an integrated vision.

But – and here is the point – we, the frontal persona, have been charged with solving an unsolvable riddle/problem. And re-establishing the natural and ideal relationship to our own core, although healthy and correct, only serves to highlight and exacerbate this twisted state of affairs. So why aren't people positively oriented already? Because, in the absence of primary level integrity, the negative and scattered orientation to life is all that remains. The shift to a positively oriented life is just not possible. The integrity such an active and positive approach would ultimately seek to embody simply cannot be found.

Which itself would tend to imply that much of the ineffectiveness we suffer in getting to where we want to be in life is not actually the result of a lack of creating power or ability, but that – because of this underlying dis-integrity – our energies spend most of their time simply pulling against each other instead. Our power is there, but turned against itself constantly. A deadlock. A conscious agenda pulling one way, and another quite separate and integrated unconscious agenda pulling the other, both affecting desire, which simply represents any and all systemic tensions to the frontal mind. And thus to feel more, in this state, is simply to create more inner tension, and still go nowhere. Both sources of desire become amplified simultaneously in this case, at loggerheads. Meaning it is generally not that constructive. And this is why we gradually stop feeling, and turn our attention outward, away from our inner worlds. Which is a huge shame. We look outward in a search for happiness, because the inside simply makes no sense. And quite so as it turns out, in this strange situation. But this is not the case naturally, nor ultimately, as I hope we will see.

So the remainder of this work will be dedicated to exposing an unfortunate complex of underlying factors which have left desire formation hobbled and dynamically conflicted at its very root, a conflict with deep and dynamic functional consequences, and which leaves us in an endless cycle of struggle. We will come to see exactly why – whilst this underlying conflict remains – if we fully embrace our desires and seek their fulfilment we are to some degree bound to endless relational frustration and confusion. Making happiness itself perplexing and in many ways elusive. So that, even when we get what we think we want, we always find it leaves us short of the kind of happiness we expected to find. But also that, conversely, because desire is such a vital function in the healthy operation of the overall human system, if we negate it because it is conflicted we face the dire risk of removing what little integrity remains. That desire cannot be ignored or negated wholesale without very serious consequences. Once again, leaving our chances of true, deep and lasting happiness out in the cold. A true double bind. A human riddle with no apparent answer. A nasty trap indeed.

This is the common human dilemma, the focus of the remainder of this work. This, therefore, has been as good a place as any to start, with a quick look at the surface of life, and the surface of this conflict. I hope this at least offers you some glimpse of the scope of what I am proposing, and how it is already reflected in your own life. Desire is an appropriate place to start in examining the underlying dilemma because the formation of primary level desire comprehensively reflects the integrity of the system as a whole. Any conflict in the formation of desire would therefore perfectly reflect an underlying conflict.

What does this mean? Logically, because an integrated vision represents the pinnacle form of

our system's most essential point of positive integrity, a conflict in desire formation would in some essential way represent the entire human dilemma. That the entire conflict, the entire human dilemma, is contained within this deceptively simple question: "what do I truly want?", and completely expressed in our inability to answer it. And it is a struggle most people can already relate to, although they often never suspect its profundity, or that it is the result of something far deeper. Perhaps because at this shallow level of depth it is impossible to differentiate native desires from added emotional noise.

We must go deeper again if we wish to examine what really goes on well beneath the surface. And so I hope - if you've been having trouble finding what you truly want in life because you just can't figure out what it is - that by the time we're finished here, you will come to understand that there are some very, very good reasons why that's so.

Appendix A

Truly Novel Thinking (and what it costs)

In terms of the overall creative process, whether that be individual or group, there are certain definable characteristics which always emerge. Certain key functions always dominate if the process is going to be powerful, all of which work together to produce a truly dynamic and balanced creative outcome.

In personal creative terms, the process we broke down into two parts at the beginning of the second half of Section One (defining and getting) can actually most accurately be broken down into three.

The first is the creative/formative stage. This is the process of establishing the desired outcome. (Sets the best destination.)

The second is the planning/organisational stage, which we have not covered in any depth at all. This is the 'how' part, and is the natural bridge between the first and third stages of this process. But as we have already indicated, this part will suffer greatly if the results of the first stage contain inherent conflicts or inconsistencies. It is obviously impossible to figure out how to create what cannot be created. (Defines/decides the best path.)

The third is the implementation/finalising stage. The actual doing bit, affecting the changes: pure transactional leverage. Action. (Actually walking the path.)

Together, these three comprise a single creative process or event: a single flow.

As we have also seen above, it is actually a natural function of a well-executed first stage to produce the energy and even set the wheels in motion for the next two, and for the actualisation of the changes it defines. This is because active desire – the result of this formative process – automatically drives both cognitive processing and physical action toward its own resolution. That is its function in the organic system that we are. So if the results of this first process are truly what you desire, and are free of conflict, then the other two stages are pure detail. It is then simply a matter of getting out of its way. So that rather than asking how you might then make it happen, you could well be asking how you could stop it happening.

Shifting context for a moment: in a powerful and dynamic group environment set up to create or achieve something, exactly the same process applies. You would have people to represent and fulfil at least five specialist functions, the three primary ones mentioned above – representing the creative process itself – and two others relating expressly to the internal and external operations of the group – the social/integrator, and the logistical/gofer.

And once again, even in this context, it is the first formative stage which has traditionally been missing, undervalued or misunderstood, for reasons we may now come to see.

This missing function is, consequently, in highest demand. And if you are capable of this, within an organisational context, then you are in the running for some pretty serious remuneration. But it would also seem to be the most difficult aspect of the whole creative process to become adept at, and to master, even to the point of being commonly perceived as something of an enigma.

In the individual context, we must develop all three of these operations on a secure and balanced footing if we are ever going to fulfil our creative potential, as a lack in any one will directly limit the effectiveness of the other two, and thus the whole process. These three functions or stages are the 'golden triangle' of effective creating, so if we wish to be creative in any sense we must all learn to wear these three distinct 'caps'.

As an aside, the other two 'caps' worn in the group context - the integrator and the gofer - are also necessary aspects in our personal process, but usually tend to happen automatically. The integrator is inward, and simply involves feeling, and keeping each of the other functions differentiated but openly communicating. This is simply the healthy inward orientation indicated throughout the whole of section one. And the gofer is outward, and is the part of us which is responsible for resourcing the whole deal, and kicks in whenever anything is needed in order to optimise effectiveness and avoid any breakdowns or delays. This could mean anything from seeking serious assistance, to knowing when it's time to get a cup of tea.

So altogether, these functions comprise our 'creative anatomy'. What we have been addressing thus far under the heading 'creating the life you truly desire' is just the first of these three stages, and only in relation to our own personal life creation. Just the creative/formative aspect, for that is where I've been asserting the main problem exists. And in defining that process in the second half of Section One, we have covered nearly everything but this one process of truly novel thinking, the third and vital stage of formulating an active and integrated personal vision. So the process I am about to cover in this appendix could, I suppose, be defined as the essential creative aspect of the essential creative stage of the entire

creative process. It is the part of that crucial first (defining 'what') stage which demands true novelty of thought. And it is also where many, it would seem, fall well short of their true creative potential, thereby stunting the entire process.

Therefore it is very important if you wish to be truly and powerfully creative. I believe it can realistically be defined as THE vital characteristic displayed by all great innovators and creators, both past and present. So if you are ever intending to achieve something really significant, this is - I believe - probably what it's going to take.

Okay - so how does it work?

I guess I can only explain how I experience it here, which may of course be completely wrong, but hopefully not, at least not entirely.

The essence of this process demands an entirely different orientation to the one you are probably used to in relation to problem solving. It is, not surprisingly, almost the exact opposite of what they taught you in school (As we will see, they should have been teaching you how to think, rather than telling you what to think. But the problem is, in terms of this particular process, they generally don't know how themselves).

The main issue here comes down to an understanding of the basic functions and capacities of the human body-mind itself. Left brain/right brain, conscious/unconscious etc. And the point is: to recognise and optimise our true functional capacity toward its most powerful and creative potential.

What have been defined as the left-brain functions are generally described as the linear or 'organisational' functions of mind. The right-brain

as the lateral or 'creative' functions (recent neuro-physiological research is beginning to question traditional left/right hemisphere definitions of brain activity, but the two distinct types of functioning are still accepted, so I'll stay with left/right terms in distinguishing them for now). And the conscious mind is capable of an incredible three to six points of attention at any one time. Yes, not so incredible after all, given that the unconscious mind upwards of 120,000 processes per second.

Our culture and education systems are seriously left brain - conscious mind dominated. You can probably already see where I am going with this.

Using the 'Power Brain'.

What I'm going to define here is a particular style of creative activity that is very powerful, but which - it is thought - may not suit everyone. It has been thought that it may be an expression of how only some people process information and develop solutions to problems. It is also commonly believed that a 'creative brain' is something you are either born with, or not; that true ingenuity is a God given talent, not something you can learn or develop; that truly original thought is something which happens in flashes of spontaneous insight, which only a few can ever hope to be lucky enough to receive in life; and that truly novel invention is purely the realm and jurisdiction of the genius mind.

Well, as usual, I disagree. On all counts (and after all, how can it be God - given that there almost certainly is no God?). But seriously, I believe the process whereby truly novel ideas and concepts are produced is something which can be defined, and which can be learned and fostered if you are

prepared to give it what it takes. That this capacity can be developed and enhanced with what actually amounts to quite a simple shift in basic orientation. And it has a lot less to do with brains, than it does with guts and passion and plain old-fashioned hard work.

We are told by developmental psychologists that cognitive capacity develops in stages, each with its distinct hallmark characteristics and *modus operandi*. From archaic, to magical, to mythic, to rational, each stage of psychological development has its own cognitive style. You can observe each of these in the development of a child. And as rational is the current adult norm, it is considered by most people to be the peak of normal development. Meaning that rational thinking is considered to be the operational ideal.

It would seem that development doesn't actually stop there, however, at least not in potential. Whole fields of psychology have now emerged to account for the arising of potentials which seem to be at a level beyond rational in their functioning. 'Transpersonal' psychology, studying 'trans-rational' states. States which presume and imply full rational capacity, but which subsume that functioning within a larger and broader operation of mind. At least three distinct states beyond the stable emergence of full rational adaptation are currently being mooted.

As an aside, the radical potential I addressed in Section Four is currently generally considered to be one of these higher developmental stages, as they have no other way of explaining it. But I believe we've seen that this is not the case at all.

Some have termed the first such development beyond pure rational functioning 'vision logic', and have generally presumed it to be some form of 'advanced rationality' - a somehow wider or better

rationality, just more of the same. But to my mind that really doesn't explain it, or its integrative power (one of its defining hallmarks).

So my assertion here is that at least a part of such functioning is what I am about to explain, the emergence of a whole new way of cognitive functioning which the arrival of full rationality simply enables. Nothing new, essentially just a new use for what was already there.

Barry Buzan, the author of 'The Mind Map Book' etc, differentiates the creative functions of mind from the organisational functions, outlining their clear differences and deeming them quite antithetical in practice: that one will tend to directly interfere with the other if applied in unison. And as I said, people have generally associated these two distinct functions with right-brain and left-brain activity respectively. However what I am proposing here is not strictly a 'right-brain' approach, as many creative pundits have advocated, marginalising left brain functions. But rather an overall orientation which facilitates an optimal use of both the organisational and creative faculties of mind in a single deeper process. True generative emergence, as I will define it, involves both right and left-brain functions, creative and organisational. Generally in that order.

The key, as I will explain, is in formulating the inquiry in such a way as to leave only the unconscious mind with the job of resolving it, using any functions it deems fit, including both the left and right brain. But the essential breakthroughs do generally seem to carry the distinct hallmarks of what has traditionally been defined as right-brain cognitive functioning. In their own 'messy' way, the creative functions seem to produce the critical leaps of insight, which the organisational functions then have to work out, fix up, and organise. So

although not strictly right-brain, because for many people right-brain functioning would seem to lay somewhat dormant in the unconscious as non-dominant, this process may be a good way of accessing it, and gaining a better left-right balance if such is desired. But in the end, the process potentially uses all of the brain's available capacities at every level, ultimately pressing its basic functions deep into the body.

In developmental terms, the potential I am indicating here is the result of the system (body) learning to use the conscious rational mind to intentionally utilise and direct the enormous power of the unconscious mind to solve problems. So that, rather than being the engine, the shallow and linear conscious mind assumes the position of the driver, and learns to steer and motivate the sleeping giant of the unconscious mind - the 'Power Brain'. Something which is, apparently, a responsibility to which it seems much better suited.

The advantages of this orientation are enormous, and compared to the common left-brain approach it is a whole new world of creative opportunity. But it is also very demanding energetically and if you are going to optimise it and reap substantial rewards without falling short or burning yourself out, you have got to manage it very carefully. Which means you've got to at least have some understanding of how it works, and how to achieve the best results with the least amount of energetic investment.

The essential process is very simple: You simply formulate a question or a problem clearly in your mind, and then feel it. You allow it to drop into your body. You do not seek to answer or resolve it, but simply feel the tension the question itself produces when you raise it in the mind, and feel it in your body. And stay with it. The idea is to get rid of the

weak and impotent conscious mind as a potential source of answers.

The normal habit is to immediately flee from this tension into frantic thinking, and looking for ways to resolve it. But the process here is to submit it to the system as an organic tension, to really live the question. To embody it.

Now what this does, to the degree you can suffer it, is seriously disturb the unconscious mind. So feeling the problem as an emotional tension will really get the unconscious going. It will take this very personally.

The system itself abhors tension, and the unconscious mind simply reflects this. It is one of the primary functions of the unconscious mind to resolve emotive tensions when they arise. That's what it does. And the unconscious is a powerhouse of creative energy. It is definitely worth having on your side if you want to get something difficult done.

Therefore, in the same way as desire or aversion produce leverage and motivate systemic functions, just so with this tension. The only difference is that we are talking about a mental/cognitive outcome this time. The tension stimulates activity at a very deep cognitive level toward the direct resolution of the tension. And that point of resolution is the real key to success here. The more carefully and clearly defined the problem is, the faster and easier the unconscious will find a way to resolve it. And the more pressure you apply, the harder it will work.

Just be warned, the unconscious is - as I said - a powerhouse of activity. Thinking takes effort (which is perhaps why so many simply don't bother), and this kind of deep organic thinking takes lots. And you'll only get out of it what you put in. Imagine the energy it takes to figure out

something difficult with your conscious mind, then imagine a process in which the conscious mind is only the driver of a much larger engine. This is why it takes brawn as much as brains, and why it is important to source your energy very well.

All cognitive and emotive functions demand and consume energy, the system's primary resource. So the system will not activate them unless it has to. Which is why the process demands tension to drive it - to produce the systemic motive. Everything the unconscious does happens for a reason, and in this case you have got to intentionally produce that reason. The conscious mind, which is supposed to work in sync with the unconscious in the resolution of tensions, is now actively generating it. This is the trick. So all the energy you would usually be using to answer the question at a conscious level, is now going into doing a really good job of simply asking it. Making trouble! You see the system would usually just let the conscious mind deal with stuff, because it's easier, and demands less work. So if the conscious mind is not only out of the picture, but actually absorbed in developing the question, you can imagine how much energy the unconscious is consuming in its efforts to resolve it. A reluctant giant, but a very powerful one.

The conscious process demands energy, as do the emotive tensions being generated, and then there are all the unconscious processes bubbling away in response to all this. So if you've got some energy you want to blow off, this is how to do it. It can produce spectacular and always unexpected results, truly novel emergences, but it is no free ride. Every bit of energy consumed is somewhere being backed up and motivated by an active systemic tension. A tension you must directly produce.

Genius is ten percent inspiration, ninety percent perspiration.

- Thomas Edison

I do not think with my head, but with my muscles.

- Attributed to Einstein

This is the energetic aspect, the primary driver of the whole process. Just as in the outer realm, it is the application of the creative tension toward a desired outcome. And just as in the outer realm, it is important where you source your motivation. This process is only going to be taken through to the resolution of serious problems by someone with a passion equivalent to the task. For even when it is refined and streamlined with experience, it is still very demanding if you are taking on big issues. So sourcing the emotional energy to feed this process seems to be a big factor in this process becoming established. It is simply too difficult to do just for fun. But as time goes by, your capacity to carry such tension becomes increased, as does the efficiency with which you direct and apply the inquiry, and you become capable of gradually addressing larger and larger problems using this creative mode. And if you are very intelligent in how you manage this process, it eventually doesn't need to take much tension at all, especially if you have the one thing the unconscious loves: time. With enough time this process could find a creative solution to HUGE problems with quite minimal tension, like dripping water cuts through rock.

We saw in the overall creative process addressed in the main part of Section One: the use of creative tension to produce intentional change. Just so, we see it here in two different forms, two different applications of the same principle. Desire, as we saw, is tension that produces inner leverage, which affects change in the outer world through affecting our behaviour. It moves by attracting us toward the

release of tension. But it is not often clearly understood that this very same principle applies equally inside us as it does outside; that we can, if we are prepared to bear the same kind of load, produce remarkable results on a purely cognitive level. So just as in outer change, tension is our primary point of leverage. That's what it takes to get the attention of the unconscious mind. And that is, therefore, also the cost of truly novel or generative thought.

In terms of 'whole' creative processes, then, activity can be defined into two distinct fields:

1. **Practical** (physical). The application of creative tension (desire/aversion) towards actual change in the realm of relational exchange[internal or external]. Changing our world or ourselves.
2. **Mental** (non-physical). The application of creative tension towards a purely mental result, cognitive processing with a cognitive/mental product. Actually creating something which did not previously exist, albeit something non-physical. An idea.

Whilst the practical form of creating can be seen as more real, the mental can possibly be viewed as more creative, in that it potentially involves the generation of something completely novel. This second potential also obviously has many applications beyond the creative formation of an integrated 'personal vision'. We can, perhaps most ethically, apply such in search of ends well beyond our own personal gain. But, it should be mentioned, because it potentially unites both forms of creativity (practical and mental), such a vision does typify the very pinnacle of personal creative capacity. Because the formulation and upholding of an integrated vision represents such a high degree of healthy systemic functioning, to use

this process of novel thought for such would appear to be its optimum potential application. Defining your personal vision is its very highest use – that obviously being the very reason all this functioning actually exists.

So here we see a complete creative process within a complete creative process. And the one within, the purely non-physical, holds the key to the integrity and power of the other, the practical ‘real life’ vision.

No wonder people can't figure out what they want. The autopilot's all fucked up as we see in Section Three, and we are not taught by the culture we inhabit how to fly this thing manually. This should all be happening automatically, but when you have to break it all down into distinct processes you soon realise just how complex we are as beings. The subject of Section Four, however, is that it just might be possible to turn the autopilot back on and thereby recover all this automatically. That is what the restoration of emotional and energetic integrity means.

Creation, both inner and outer, requires the capacity and willingness to generate, embrace and maintain a high degree of tension over time. Tension means effort and energy. The greater the creation, the greater the tension is usually the rule. But defining the outcome is the key. Without a clear resolution focus, any tension is completely worthless, or at least extremely inefficient.

In Section One, in the context of the formulation of what you truly want (your integrated vision), the question this process is used to address is the synthesis of all the elements which the first two stages of that process (feeling and extracting core elements) have produced. And the point of ‘resolution’ for the unconscious mind is the definition of a situation or circumstance that would

truly represent all of those elements in a single picture. And as I said in that section, the key is to strip the question down to its core elements. For this is the creative strength of the power-brain. It is powerful enough to ask this deeper level question, and not have to deal with the confusion of old surface structures. It is powerful enough to start fresh, and thereby to bypass all historical conditioning and error. And make no mistake, there is far more error in what we think we know, than there is truth.

That's how it basically works, then. And the same thing applies to any other question or problem being addressed in this way, using this process. If you do not strip away all historical answers to the question at hand, you are limiting the capacity of this process to generate a truly powerful and creative solution. So I'll keep going and explain this further, as it may help to further understand just why this avoidance of existing 'answers' or predetermined 'corruption' of the pure creative event is so necessary in stage two of the vision formulation process.

Refining the Inquiry

Apart from learning how to handle and direct the creative tension, the other thing which develops is your capacity to direct the form of the inquiry toward a point of resolution which is both clear and efficient, but which also demands the maximum creative capacity of the unconscious mind.

I'll start off with how to stimulate the most creative response:

It is always much easier, but much less creative, to solve a problem using someone else's pre-formulated answers, in the same way that it is always much easier to begin the question of what

you truly want with some of the things you already have. This is the inherently fearful and limited left-brain, or conscious-mind approach. The conscious mind functions like a kind of librarian, and uses only the resources it already has as such. It is not creative. The best it can do is regurgitate a whole lot of historical answers to something, and seek to reformulate something new out of them. It is like a storehouse for information, bits and pieces of historical stuff. So the results of conscious inquiry often appear very rapidly, just like an index search at the library. But it's all old stuff. Many people confuse this kind of combination of existing elements with actually being creative. But true innovation comes from the workshop, not the library. It comes from where things are made, not where things are stored. And this workshop is in the 'Power Brain', the teeming unconscious.

So although it may make a problem easier to resolve if you start off with some parts of that solution already filled in, it also limits the potential of the unconscious to radically re-address an entire issue with a breakthrough realisation. True breakthroughs require radical relinquishment of what already exists. A truly blank canvas. Too much reverence for those who have gone before is precisely what prevents us from going forwards. And the same applies to holding onto your past, or what you have now, in relation to what you might have in the future. What you have now is often the problem, not the answer. So if there are already tracks in the snow, it is very tempting for your mind to follow the same path, and thus repeat the same mistakes as whoever put them there. Thus, conformity and creativity are diametrically opposed. All truly progressive advances come from outside the current structure, from completely beyond the incumbent paradigm.

Ultimately, although it is more difficult, the most creative path you can take in using this mode of

creation is to eliminate all traces of historical answers or solutions to the particular problem - or group of problems - being addressed. This is the primary act of true ingenuity or inventiveness: to have a very careful and considered approach to what has gone before, ultimately a disrespectful approach, to not accept anything as gospel. It is to seek to eliminate all tacit assumptions, and reduce the problem down to its bare bones again. Which of course requires much more construction and process in finding new resolution, and is thus the harder path. Of course many questions are simply too big for most people to start from scratch in this way, and - especially at the beginning - they may have to dilute the process and start with certain parts already filled in. But to carefully limit these is the true key to opening this process up to its full creative potential. To have historical answers present when you are addressing a problem is like the presence of noise when you are trying to compose music.

The ideal in this process, for optimum creative power, is to eliminate all traces of historical surface structure from the core problem or issue. And, in the process I am indicating here, this is the job of the conscious mind. Apart from holding the tension, this is the primary discipline. The key is to define the point of resolution, the conditions the finished article must fulfil, in core terms free of anything added. We must learn how to strip issues of their surface structure, to reveal their core. What this basically means is a preparedness to **question everything**. To **not** collect and accumulate these old answers as the conscious mind is so used to doing, but to directly eliminate them, and thus make the whole process **harder**, and the tension **more** intense. To deepen the question.

Remember, you are not looking for an answer.

What do you mean we are not looking for an answer? No, we are **creating** an answer, and this is a very different thing. So the answer is not out there somewhere, or in the past, or even in the mind itself. **It is in the question.** And it is not the job of the conscious mind to answer the question, but to progressively explore and refine and boil the question down to its raw state, free of foot-ups, but also free of all cock-ups ('cock-up' is Kiwi slang for regrettable mistake).

One effective way to do this is to write it: In refining the question, write about it, expand it, explore it, get to the essence. Writing is, in a sense, a form of self discovery. So write, and rewrite. Boil the question down on paper. This stimulates the unconscious.

Resolving the problem, as it becomes refined down in this way, would simply be too much work for the conscious mind to even comprehend. But with the Power Brain we can afford to offer these essential issues in their raw and undiluted state. In which case it has the most potential of producing a truly creative outcome. And, which is the point, it will not be confused or misdirected by someone else's historical mistakes in the process. So this orientation effectively creates work, but it also eliminates confusion and optimises creative potential. It is to not let the mind take the easy predictable path. Which is what most people do, and why they can sometimes live their entire lives and never have a single original thought. This doubt, as exemplified by Plato, is the ultimate key. Question everything. Historical answers or part answers are the easy path, the left-brain path, the non-creative path.

Truly novel creation is the result of effectively giving your unconscious no other choice, of forcing it to cut a new path. You must steer away from historical answers and refine the essential question down.

What I've just outlined is the main tenet of how to formulate the question for maximum creative effect. And you may be able to see now why it is important in the formulation of an active vision to seek to extract the core issues from the historical surface structures, and how doing so radically increases your potential for leaps of insight. Which is the real strength of this mode of inquiry. It can, if it is unrestricted, produce extraordinary results. It is very lateral in effect, if it is applied without reservation. So whenever - in formulating your personal vision - you adhere to or impose any set surface structure which must be in the final picture, and which you therefore are not prepared to submit to this process, you are severely limiting your own creative potential, and your chances of being happy. After all, the question is "what do I want?" So if you do really want it, then you don't have to worry, it will appear in the finished vision. What are you afraid of? If your life will not tolerate honesty in this sense, it will also not tolerate happiness. Are you really prepared to follow your truest passion in life? This process is where that commitment becomes manifest. The natural creative integrity and potential of a truly creative emergence is lost precisely to the degree aspects of the outcome are pre-supposed or pre-determined.

If attachment is the source of the predetermination in this case, then fear is the limiting factor. This is another example of the negative orientation, being motivated by negative energy. And although it's probably not strictly true, I'm tempted to say that nothing truly creative ever came out of fear.

If laziness is the motivation for using old answers, then you are placing yourself at the continual mercy of the past, or other peoples inherent fallibilities and limitations. You will be doomed to re-enact every past mistake. So unless you really enjoyed your past, then obviously don't use it to

determine your future. And unless the people whose opinions you are revering are demonstrably significantly happier than you are, the same clearly applies. Don't ever make the mistake of thinking others are more intelligent, or know more about life than you do. Especially your life in particular – you are the only expert in that sphere. So, all in all, if you are going to use 'head-starts' in your creative process, then make sure they come from your own head, and choose them very carefully.

Too Hard?

What we see here, then, is the essential process in its most creative mode, the essential disciplines: the generation of tension, the boiling down of the problem, and the stripping away of historical answers. Actually, in practice, it is the other way around, the refining of the question must come before it is submitted to the system as a feeling inquiry. These are the two main tenets of this process, in this order. Anyway, the more tension, and the more 'raw' or 'core' the question, the greater the creative potential. It is a combination with more power, but which also makes the whole endeavour more difficult, thereby requiring more energy and tension to drive, or simply more time to reach the point of resolution. And this is why many give up or cop-out long before ever experiencing their first primary level breakthrough.

So it is certainly not just about carrying the load of the creative tension. That's just the necessary by-product. And not just about forcing a creative path to be taken. It is also crucially important that the whole process is directed with both focus and clarity. If you ask a silly question, you'll get a silly answer. And if you ask lots of questions simultaneously, you will spread your creative energy too thin and increase the time your unconscious will take to resolve them. If you ask

lots of silly questions all together, with lots of gusto and emotional investment, you'll just make yourself suffer. Your unconscious won't care, it doesn't know the difference, all it's interested in is resolving the tension.

Therefore, now that you have an idea of the basic process, my last points here relating to understanding this process will be regarding the things you can do – or be aware of – to create efficiencies. A bit of practical advice. They're pretty obvious mostly, and generally come down to conserving or better focussing energy toward the desired point of resolution. Making it all more efficient and less demanding, more 'liveable'. After all, if it's too hard, you simply won't do it. So in the end, it is often this very mundane level of management that ultimately determines success. So in the end the tension and the conditions under which it will be resolved are the essential practical issues which drive this process, and both of these are defined by the question. This process implies a whole new way of asking questions, of developing questions, and of refining questions. In fact this whole process is essentially defined by how you ask the questions. It is a whole new way of relating to the problem or question or issue at hand.

Therefore, presuming that the process of refinement and the application of the tension are well in hand, here are some other things to consider which may make creative life a bit easier:

1. Clear space mentally. Remove all the other chatter and clutter. Avoid distracting the mind. The unconscious can perhaps answer many questions at once, but the conscious mind simply can't ask them in that way, not with any clarity. So take the load off in terms of other mental activity. Clear the decks.

This applies strongly to relational factors in life. It is obviously the job of the system you are utilising here to manage the continued fulfilment of your needs, so if you are unsure where your next meal is going to be coming from then don't expect to be able to utilise too much unconscious capacity. It will be very busy already. You need free energy and attention, and in pure relational terms that inevitably comes down to money. So, and here is a key, if you can turn whatever creative capacity you have into free energy and attention (money), you are in a potential positive spiral. Money, by clearing the load, can offer you more creative capacity, provided you don't simply squander or save it. Creativity is expensive, and solving huge problems could easily put you into deep debt. This is why most people who discover such creative power only use it to make money, rather than doing something good with it. It is simply very difficult to do something that costs lots of money, but which does not make any. So this is something that itself can be a distraction, as it becomes necessary to creatively overcome. In the end, if you are doing something for the world, tell the world about it and get support from those who ultimately stand to benefit. And if they don't support it, you are obviously wasting your time. There is no point giving people something if they don't want it.

2. Narrow the question, break it up into bits and address them individually wherever you can. Focus your creative energy, going for penetration rather than span. Some questions can be broken down. It's hard by the yard, but a cinch by the inch. Start small, practice finding resolution. Don't bite off more than you can chew (Unfortunately, the primary question- 'what do I want?', when formulating it into a vision, cannot be broken up in this way so easily. It's a biggie.).

3. Move! This process generates tension in the body-mind. And the unconscious is intrinsically

connected to physical functioning. Do things that stimulate the unconscious, things which juice up that level of activity, whilst leaving the conscious mind free to ask the press question. Stand and bounce a ball against the wall, and things which shake out the tension this process can build up in the body. Massage it. Jump on a rebounder. Play the question. Drive the question. Fuck the question. Chuck things around. Dance it. Express it any way you can, physically, or simply move and engage the hand-eye reflexes that stimulate the motor cortex and thereby stir the unconscious pot.

4. Don't push it. To ask too big, and too hard, for too long, is not actually a productive approach. Find a balance. Too much of this can easily make you sick! It squeezes your body like a toothpaste tube, feeding energy into the unconscious mind. Creativity is NOT a matter of intelligence. It's just hard labour. If you want to see what a truly innovative creative process can cost you, go ask John Britten. This stuff can literally take you out of the game. Keep an eye on stress, and watch out for burnout. Tension is necessary, but don't confuse tension with stress. There is such a thing as healthy tension. A sufficient level of tension, if you have the time, is about what you would feel if you have an itch you can't quite scratch. It agitates emotionally, but it doesn't hurt physically. It is very dangerous to adopt an approach that you could not sustain, because it always takes much longer than you imagine, and costs much more. Don't ever hold your breath unless you know exactly how far you have to swim.

5. Choose your creations carefully. Make sure they 'pay off' somehow or your system will not support the next endeavour. There is a lot of talk here of tension and that creating demands such, but it should always be kept in mind that the very point of the systems tension generation functions are to move us toward a tension free state. GOOD tension

results in NO tension. Like fighting fire with fire. Desire, expressed inwardly or outwardly, is a tension which drives us toward what we want, and once we have that we experience no tension. So to maintain what we want does not demand tension. I just didn't want you to think that to be truly creative you have to be perpetually managing some great degree of tension. In fact quite the opposite is the case, the greatest creations may demand great tension to create, but the freedom from tension they deliver should always substantially outweigh the cost – this is the whole point. This is the only thing that makes creativity intelligent.

So the best result, for purely energetic reasons, will come in the direction of your truest passion. Your Calling, your Daemon. For that will give you the energy for the act itself. Lots of energy is exactly what defines such. If you don't have a seemingly bottomless supply of emotional energy for a creation, then it is not your 'calling'. Desire is actually the factor by which you can gauge the amount of free energy a creation will liberate, thus how much tension it will remove. So creating what you truly desire is the ultimate context for this creative process, this is what it should be used for, so keep it in line with that and you'll discover that finding the emotional energy is simply not a problem. Tension may be the process, but no tension must always be the destination. You must always gain more than you give.

6. A clear and single point or resolution at every stage. Asking too many questions at once scatters the creative tension. This is the positive orientation once again, and it applies in this context very distinctly, because it is all necessarily motivated by negative tension. So without a positive focus, the negative orientation naturally overwhelms this. Don't scatter the unconscious' energy.

The man who chases two rabbits, goes hungry.

- Old Chinese proverb

The question itself, or the problem, always contains within it the crucial point of resolution towards which the unconscious will strive. If that point is unclear, or keeps shifting, or if there are simultaneously several, the process will to that same degree be ineffective. Without a clear finish line, the creative tension is pointless, worthless and redundant. The clearer you can make the finish line, in positive singular terms, the easier it will be to reach.

An example: 'What do I not want?' is a question with no definable point of resolution. The answer is never ending. Whereas 'What do I really want?' has a definable and finite target destination. And the unconscious will work equally hard on either, but will only find resolution on one. To focus on what you don't want is like pissing into the wind - it doesn't have the desired effect, it feels good only very temporarily.

7. And finally, perhaps the most important of all: the integrity of the question itself. This is where the real trouble can come. I am not speaking of moral or ethical integrity here, but practical. If the question contains inherent logical inconsistencies, then there is no point of resolution. You can ask such a question forever and never get an answer. The Power Brain can answer huge questions in very novel ways, solve massive problems, but still only ones which can actually be answered and resolved. Some questions have no answer, because they make no sense. They have no integrity. Like trying to figure out exactly how fast an 'inch' is. So the most important of all considerations is to make

sure your fundamental terms of reference are not confused or conflicted.

If you finished the main body of Section One before reading this you will recognise that what I am talking about here is exactly the case with desire. And that in the final stage of a proposed and otherwise 'ideal' process of formulating what you truly want in life, we mysteriously hit the wall with an unsolvable and unfathomable question. And the deeper we take the first two stages of that process, the deeper the apparent confusion in the third. Which can lead us to question the process itself. But that is the right process. It is just that the fundamental terms of reference - desires - have had their native integrity disturbed. Making the third stage of that 'vision' process a question which actually has no answer. It is simply not possible to resolve. Sorry, I realise that's probably not what you wanted to know. That's what this whole book is about.

Seeing it in Action

This process is not institutionalised in any significant way in common culture. People adept at this are often not recognised or rewarded socially. In fact it emerges in spite of, not because of, our present cultural attitude toward it. Which is a great shame.

All this could well be because of the way it appears in practice, as contrasted with the common approach. It can seem very strange and frustrating to those who do not understand it.

The common 'shallow' approach to problem solving is often to simply survey what is already known about a particular issue, and - on the basis of that - to make a judgement resulting in choosing a direction from whatever paths or options

immediately present themselves, and committing energy in a singular manner down that path. And there is a lot to be said for this commitment and for this approach. If the answers have already been found, then this approach will often reap rewards. However, if your research consists of researching other peoples research, then how do you know that their research is not simply research of other peoples research.....ad infinitum? Perhaps an overly dramatic simplification, though you get my point. It eliminates anything novel, bar the occasional new connection or synthesis.

The essence of the deeper way is to absolutely avoid committing to any particular train of thought, to any opinion, but to simply 'invite the question in', to develop and expand it, not to seek to answer it. The deeper way primarily involves emotional investment in the resolution of the issue. The more investment, the more functional involvement. It is a 'whole body' approach. To LIVE the question, to breathe the question, to altogether become absorbed in the question and not be tempted to answer it. To feel the tension and just relax and allow the question to be there, unresolved.

So 'Power Brain' users tend to immerse themselves in the inquiry, to fully engage it bodily, to allow it to wash through them, and to embody the tension of the question itself. Whereas the 'lefties' tend to avoid such tension, opting for quick but shallow resolution. Therefore, consciously, the approach is problem oriented, rather than answer oriented. "I want to know the real question!", rather than "what is the real answer?" A strange orientation: to NOT seek an answer. And this is another common criticism based on a shallow misunderstanding of all this, that it seems to meander through a morass of dead end crevasses in its 'feeling out' of the inquiry, that it is not a very linear or predictable approach at all.

The world wants things now! And if you are going to make a living solving problems, you've got to be able to do it to a deadline. So this is another issue - TIME. It's not very predictable or reliable. The deeper process, once established, will take a certain amount of time to percolate a final resolution, and cannot be effectively rushed without a loss of creative/innovative potential. You have to stay with it, and learn to play the tension over time. It is an organic process, and it can't simply be turned off and on like the conscious mind. It is a continuous process which bubbles away even whilst you sleep. It is common for this deeper process to continue its appropriate gestation well past a forced deadline, and to complete its cycle in its own good time. Even, sometimes, when a solution is no longer needed. The unconscious is big, like an oil tanker it's hard to get moving, but it is also hard to stop because once it's rolling it is all pure momentum.

Common culture effectively eliminates this potential by the way we manage time and resources so as to not respect or accommodate it. Which never stops so-called 'progressive companies' complaining that their staff just 'aren't very creative'. What they fail to understand is that - like gardening - creativity is a process, not an event, and that it must be given the appropriate resources it requires.

This process is also intrinsically 'unreliable' in the sense that you can't issue a 'progress report'. The conscious mind simply doesn't know. And even when the answer arrives, it doesn't really know how it was reached. It would seem that the strength of this deeper process is that it doesn't consult or involve the frontal mind. It is not very orderly or organised, the unconscious thrives on chaos. But one thing is reliable about it, that this process - although seeming slow or indirect in some ways -

is actually a far more truly creative or innovative approach if it is governed correctly and allowed time to process its full cycle in its own way. It can answer huge questions in radically divergent ways with actually quite moderate degrees of tension if the inquiry is focused, and it is given the time required.

This deeper approach is ultimately intimidating, however, as it tends more toward revolutionary thinking, whilst the shallow tends towards conservative and moderate. Thus the deeper is often more threatening, as it usually proposes more/deeper change from what is known. It can really rock the boat by challenging the status quo. Once again, we see the shallow approach's true face: fear.

This deeper process is non-linear, problem focussed, emotionally involved, unreliable, unpredictable, and can seem to take a long time with little obvious progress. But when a problem is finally resolved, and a solution crystallised, that solution is invariably revolutionary, novel, laterally oriented, innovative and often virtually complete even if it requires significant translation into a chronological sequence or logical framework.

This is the last great criticism, another drawback from a practical perspective: that the unconscious mind functions in a highly organic language, and that although you may 'know' the answer, you may be - initially at least - at a loss to explain it rationally. For even though such an explanation may be possible, it does not arrive as such, because it was not developed in rational terms, nor with rational machinery. So the initial creative part is just the half of it. Then comes the organising bit. Getting the unconscious to 'deliver' it is one thing, but it sometimes takes just as long to 'unpack' it. This unpacking is, most appropriately, a left-brain

task. It must be logically checked for consistency, and, to whatever degree possible, tested.

Before this second part is applied, the initial emergence can often seem difficult to substantiate or even explain. You see this in schools all the time, people having their core intuitions crushed, before they have an opportunity to fully develop and test them. Crazy. So who are the children in this case – the students or the teachers? The children often know more about creativity and the power of play than the teachers can even remember.

So the organisational aspects of the creative process come next in this process, and for a very creative person this can involve a great deal of labour. Truly novel emergence is only the first part of the process, and often takes a lot of figuring out. This figuring out is the completion stage, and it is completely different again. Indeed, a truly creative person in the generative sense may not be very good at this part at all.

The primary deep process of creation in this sense simply asks the unconscious mind to deliver a kind of radical sum total. The organisational processes must then seek to define the equation associated with this novel factor, to structure it in a rational manner. And it is in this organisational stage when the conscious functions come to the fore again. They must then set about re-organising and building new surface structure to fit the brand new chassis.

Cultural Ignorance

Using only the conscious mind with its very limited resources, and avoiding tension at all costs, people tend to oscillate between two powerless states. They have a choice: between broad subject matter

with shallow inquiry or narrow subject matter with deeper inquiry.

Learning to access the functional resources of the unconscious mind increases your overall capacity for truly creative and powerful problem solving and understanding. Thus it allows you to go broader AND deeper, rather than broader OR deeper. This is why examples of truly original insights, developments, or breakthroughs in the field of integrated paradigms are so particularly rare. Paradigms are the biggest answers to the biggest questions, and as we've seen, the real groundbreaking is done when you pull away any current or known head starts or answer fragments, and boil the question down. So the truly creative emergence of the core of an integrated paradigm - beyond anything which currently exists, and thus from the ground up - is one of the most difficult of all possible questions to embody and answer. It is, by definition - in the defining and refining half of the process - a simultaneous and unlimited widening AND deepening of the question and the subject matter. It is literally a field of inquiry so epic that even a very intelligent mind would struggle to fully comprehend and define just the question, let alone begin the far greater process of actually answering it. And the tension necessarily associated with the successful resolution of this level of creative activity is obviously equally massive in potential intensity, duration, or both.

But the significance of such emergent ideas? Well, they can literally change the world. Such people are - I believe - the true heroes amongst us. But despite offering sometimes significant contributions to the real betterment of humankind, they generally go unsung in our culture, as we idolise and adulate appearance over substance in the form of actors, and Neanderthal gladiators in the artificial arena of sport. Both of which are devoid of substantial contribution to our overall

state of being, which is going steadily down the gurgler whilst our attentions are thus transfixed. Really, the most promising sign that there is intelligent life somewhere else in the universe, is that it doesn't come here. We are ingenious little monkeys, when we're not being so completely bloody stupid.

The problem regarding this process in our culture seems to be that the whole endeavour of true generative creation is almost entirely subjective, and thus not socially obvious. The result may be obvious, but the preceding process often isn't, and nor is the cost obvious, or recognised.

So from the typical left brain - conscious perspective it all seems very insignificant as an achievement. Because you can't see the unconscious working. Because it gestates quietly and slowly. In fact, from an ignorant observer's point of view, it seems like nothing's happening at all, and then..... pop! Just 'out of the blue', a 'miracle'!

Hardly. So the common perception is of a spontaneous emergence, an enigmatic event, which 'just came', despite the person doing 'nothing particularly constructive' at all. Whereas in fact this spontaneous emergence was preceded by a very distinct process of labour and deliberate intent, but just not one which the left brain types recognise or take notice of. And just so, because the resolution did not issue from the left brain rational machinery, they generally perceive the person and the process as somewhat pre-rational, as 'gifted', as if to say it all just 'happened' to them. Well, if only that were so. The fact is, that most of the brilliantly creative characters in history have been inwardly and quite obviously tortured by their passion, and I believe the process I'm outlining here could well explain why, and also why the truly creative can also appear very neurotic or disturbed

at times. They ARE disturbed, but not by uncontrollable psychological dysfunction. Just like a neurotic, there is a lot of activity going on in the unconscious, but in this case such is deliberately stimulated with conscious intent. And just like neurotics, the 'highly charged' creative person can be prone to outbursts and breakdowns as a result of the inherent stress this process involves.

Here we see the so-called 'artistic temperament'. They often 'run hot'. But really, as an aside, not all artists are creative, not in this sense. Art and creativity have long been seriously confused. There is nothing necessarily creative about simply vomiting the contents of your mind onto a canvas or into music. That's not even left-brain, it's no brain, and completely shallow. However many artists do obviously display the signs of true creativity, and it shows in their work (Although you do have to wonder, looking back at their work, what kinds of questions some of the great creative minds might have been asking). So there is nothing inherently artistic about this process, though it can certainly be applied in that context to great effect. You don't have to be in any way artistic to be truly creative.

In fact, contrary to common perception, in this sense science is often considerably more truly creative than art. Historically, this process of generating truly novel ideas from nothing can be seen to have been applied often and to great effect at the leading edges of scientific inquiry, if only because it is a trans-rational function, that science supports the necessary capacity to take the process to its completion by properly unpacking the primary creative emergence with the rational functions of mind. And perhaps because the questions science asks have an inherent integrity. Because they are addressing an integrated subject matter: reality. And this is a very good use for this

process, because as we saw in Section Two reality is clearly what this creative hardware is intended to address. Einstein again –

The important thing is not to stop questioning. Curiosity has its reason for existing. One cannot help but be in awe when he contemplates the mystery of eternity, of life, of the marvellous structure of reality. It is enough if one tries merely to comprehend a little of this mystery every day. Never lose a healthy curiosity.

Most of the great scientific discoveries have been the result of a primary formative intuition, which then led to the construction of supporting theory. Theories which, when tested, stood up to their claims. So when I make the distinction between the common shallow approach and the deeper one, these should not be confused with scientific and artistic respectively. As the shallow approach would seem to be displayed as much – if not more – in art as in science.

So anyway, because it is an invisible act, creative people are often seen as lazy, irresponsible, disorganised, neglectful, and lacking any degree of seriousness (Mozart etc..). But all of these are merely the result of being very serious, and very busy, in an arena which cannot be observed. It's just not obvious to the naked eye. But their work, the results of their labour, do give tally to their deeds, and testament to the battles they have internally waged in landscapes we cannot see. And this should not be taken away from them by dismissing them as 'gifted' or 'savant'. Truly novel creativity does not simply happen to you, this is precisely what I am explaining here. Anyone can do it, if they are prepared to count the scars. It is a labour of love. A distinct and – if the subject matter is significant – often extraordinarily arduous process of gestation and development,

culminating in the eventual emergence - often quite suddenly - of something completely novel. Like having a baby. Except in this case the gestation and labour are not as obvious.

If the season of Spring was music, what would it sound like? Play it in your head now. Can't? To capture it you would really have to sit with that season for a time, seek its essence and elementary flavour, let it wash over and fill your whole being, until music just started to play in your heart. Then, and only then, could you begin to write. It is not enough to be able to write inky marks on parchment, if you want to be Vivaldi, or even truly play his music, you've got to be able to FEEL. And feel what he felt. So great artists do more than produce a likeness or a tone, they capture an essence, an essence they feel, rather than what they see or hear. Thus, with the feeling of a hot summer's day pulsing through their veins, what Vivaldi heard as music Monet put on canvas. And their work was only finished when it had captured that essence.

It can be of anything, rendered in any medium, but the core process is the same. In science the process is also the same, though the subject matter usually has a bit more practical relevance, and is thus often more practically significant.

My point here is that it is not generally acknowledged what true innovation costs those who undertake it. Which is a warning I guess: do not expect to be understood. In a world of mental laziness and slavery, to be creative is a silent and invisible task. Often thankless. Therefore choose your reasons well, give only what you can give unconditionally. Because truly creative people often suffer for their preparedness to follow their passion through some seriously tense and arduous territory. And in doing so they also suffer from their preparedness - and capacity - to feel. And this

should be known, because it is an important fact concerning the act of creation, and ignorance of it may prevent it from being taken into account. The result of which would be creative endeavours which are under-resourced . If you are expecting it to be easier than it really is, the only thing you will gain is disillusionment. Generative creation, in the sense I am outlining it here, is a searching and demanding process.

Not Thinking: Feeling

You can actually just pick this whole process up from being around people who do it. A kind of symbiotic transmission over time, provided there is sufficient depth of contact to enable the underlying process to be gleaned from the outside. But where do you go to find such people? There is not even a name for it in our language. There are too few adepts at present, and no 'cultural signposts' to help us recognise them.

In light of what we saw in the first half of Section One, you also have to wonder if the left-brain, conscious-mind domination in our culture and education systems is really due to the perceived value of that particular orientation, or whether it reflects what is actually just an outright flight from feeling. For, if you can't feel as the result of being riddled with unfinished emotional business, you simply can't avail yourself of this deeper creative orientation, because it is totally founded in feeling. Feeling very deeply is what makes it work.

This is also paradoxically why creative people can themselves sometimes seem neurotic and psychologically overcrowded. Rather than being bursting at the seams with unresolved emotional process, some people may find themselves with many empty rooms in the psychological inn so to speak - spare cognitive and emotional capacity left

over. Something left. But instead of simply squandering that, they do the ethical thing and decide to take in some lost and troubled tenants – questions that nobody else wants, and that have found no home. And these questions can be noisy and demanding tenants to live with. But they can also make a big difference in the world because they are inevitably some of the hardest and most significant nuts to crack. Therefore, although truly creative individuals may sometimes resemble neurotic types in some ways, they are usually at the extreme other end of the spectrum. So whilst they may be very disturbed, they are not mad – they are in fact intentionally disturbed, as disturbed as possible even, because this is what they have chosen to give. When they are asked to give, they give the most they can possibly give: themselves.

Even more paradoxical, then, those in the middle, the ‘lefties’, are the ones considered ‘healthy’. This is a massive cultural error. These are the great majority of people, who take the most, and give the least. In confusing the trans-rational with the pre-rational, in our ignorance we have consistently alienated and undervalued the very thing that could be our greatest hope for the future: those rare few who are capable and prepared to do what it takes to blaze trails we all might one day follow.

So if we are going to make such creativity and vision available to the people who will create our future, we must somehow learn to recognise these people, and produce social structures to reflect that recognition. We need to find exemplars for such, and establish them as models, so that we can stop turning our potential geniuses into mindless drones. We need to teach our children that to think and be passionate at the same time is not only possible but necessary, and – in the process – to ultimately teach them the inherent value of learning how to question the very authority with which we ourselves deliver such to them. We need

to show them the kind of creative dancing you can do around a bonfire of worthless textbooks. We have no idea what kind of world they are going to live in, and we should stop imagining we do, and simply teach them how to be creative and adaptable and to always take the initiative.

So anyway, there you have it: what it means to take the creative bull by the horns: **Create a tension by feeling the problem, define the problem so as to clearly indicate its point of resolution, and give the unconscious everything it needs in order to find that point. Free its energy from other demands, narrow the focus, break it down into bits, anything except offering it any historical head starts. Those are the bits we must pull away if the results are going to be anything truly novel.**

In the end, if we are seeking to jump out of whatever conceptual prison you may find yourself in, you may benefit from learning how to use and trust this process: to wake this sleeping giant. Asking questions and simply staying with them – meditating on them, embodying them – is the way. Freeing this giant from other massive functional demands promotes true creativity. So if you simply ask a question, no matter how difficult, and are prepared to stay with it to the point of resolution without running off and trying to answer it yourself in some linear conscious way, the result (apart from an increase of immediate tension during the process) will potentially be the emergence of a spontaneous, powerful, non-linear, and generally ‘mysterious’ insight. Usually one worth waiting for. Only at the point when you have truly assimilated and ‘lived’ the question, the answer will be obvious. When you have sufficiently ‘become’ the question, the heart of the answer will just spontaneously and effortlessly flood your being. It will simply spontaneously appear out of nothing right in the middle of the powerful vacuum

or void the question is creating. It will come right out of the ether, out of the void. But of course some questions obviously take more 'becoming' than others.

This is what this process does, it creates a mystery in your mind, a vacuum, and the universe abhors a vacuum. So if you won't let it go, then the universe simply fills it with something, with whatever will make it go away, as defined by the point of resolution your conditions prescribe. You've just got to hold it, and wait.

The most beautiful thing we can experience is the mysterious. It is the source of all true art and science.

- Einstein again

***Some men see things as they are, and say "why?"
I dream of things that never were, and say "why not?"***

-George Bernard Shaw

It will not be an old idea, and it will not have come out of the realms of the known. It will never have existed before within the structure which has now created it. It will be new. A truly original thought. You make it up. Only at this point are you creative. This is what it takes. Hard labour. So don't look around you or back into history to find truly creative potentials in your life, don't take the easy option of relying on old answers and old questions because these are what have got you to where you are now. Most of the current surface structure answers to the most important questions have already been expanded, extrapolated and 'evolved' to the point of virtual extinction in any useful sense. They have been exhausted, and have not got us to where we need to be. They are thus well past their 'use-by' date. The most creative and

intelligent answers have not yet been found, because the most important and well formulated questions have not yet been asked. Don't fast-track the process to save yourself the tension by trying to recompile a stack of old answers into something new. The answer you are looking for in the process of true creativity is exactly what you DON'T know. To begin with the premise or belief that you know the answer is to limit and confine yourself to the 'creation graveyard' of the past. The lunar landing module was not made from old motorcycle parts.

The heart of true creativity involves creating an intelligent tension and simply allowing the rest to happen. It involves sensitivity, patience, and real tenacity. It is an organic process and takes time to bear its fruit, which - once it's ripe - simply falls into your lap.

This has ended up huge. I gloss over things so quickly in my mind thinking they're pretty simple, but when I come to explaining them they end up bigger than I expect. But this is an important issue, perhaps the important issue in the field of creating, so I had to put it in. Anyway, I only hope it has all made some kind of sense, and didn't bore you to death.

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